

Downloaded from Hare-Krishna.org. Remember to install the sanskrit fonts before reading. (The fonts, as well as 50 other books by Srila Prabhupada, can be downloaded for free from Hare-Krishna.org.)

Çré Brahma - saàhitä

Verse Contents

Bs Foreword

Foreword

The materialistic demeanor cannot possibly stretch to the transcendental autocrat who is ever inviting the fallen conditioned souls to associate with Him through devotion or eternal serving mood. The phenomenal attractions are often found to tempt sentient beings to enjoy the variegated position which is opposed to undifferentenced monism. People are so much apt to indulge in transitory speculations even when they are to educate themselves on a situation beyond their empiric area or experiencing jurisdiction. The esoteric aspect often knocks them to trace out immanence in their outward inspection of transitory and transformable things. This impulse moves them to fix the position of the immanent to an indeterminate impersonal entity, no clue of which could be discerned by moving earth and heaven through their organic senses.

The lines of this booklet will surely help such puzzled souls in their march towards the personality of the immanent lying beyond their sensuous gaze of inspection. The very first stanza of this publication will revolutionize their reserved ideas when the nomenclature of the Absolute is put before them as “Kåñëa.” The speculative mind would show a tendency of offering some other attributive name to designate the unknown object. They will prefer to brand Him by their experience as the “creator of this universe,” “the entity beyond phenomena”—far off the reference of any object of nature and void of all transformation. So they will urge that the very fountainhead should have no conceivable designation except to show a direction of the invisible, and inaudible

untouchable, nonfragrant and unperceivable object. But they will not desist from contemplating on the object with their poor fund of experience. The interested enquirer will be found to hanker after the records left by erudite savants to incompatible hallucinative views of savage demonstration. In comparing the different names offered by different thoughts of mankind, a particular judge would decide in favor of some nomenclature which will suit best his limited and specific whims. The slave mentality of an individual will no doubt offer invective assertions to the rest who will be appealing to him for a revelation of his decision. To remedy this evil, the hymns of the accepted progenitor of the phenomena would do great help in taking up the question of nomenclature which is possessed of adequate power to dispel all imaginations drawn out of their experiencing the phenomena by their tentative exploitations.

The first hymn will establish the supremacy of the Absolute Truth, if His substratum is not shot by the bullets of limited time, ignorance and uncomfortable feeling, as well as by recognizing the same as an effect instead of accepting Him as the prime cause. He will be satisfied to mark that the object of their determination is the par“excellent Supreme Lord Çré Kåñëa who has eternally embodied Himself in His ever-presence, all-blissful, all-pervasive perfected knowledge as the very fountainhead of all prime causes of unending nonbeginning time, the supplying fosterer of all entities, viz., mundane and transcendental.

The subsequent lines will go to determine the different aspects of the Absolute, who are but emanations of the supreme fountainhead Kåñëa, the attractive entity of all entities. Moreover, the derivative proclamation of the nomenclature will indicate the plane of uninterrupted, unending, transcendental felicity and the nomenclature Himself is the source of the two components which go by the names of efficient and material causes. The very transcendental name “Kåñëa” is known as the embodiment of all the transcendental eternal rasas as well as the origin of all eclipsed conceptions of interrupted rasas found in the mentality of animated beings which are successfully depicted by litterateurs and rhetoricians for our mundane speculation.

The verses of Brahma-saàhitä are a full elucidation of the origination of

phenomenal and noumenic conceptions. The hymns of the incarnated prime potency has dealt fully with the monotheistic speculations of different schools which are busy to give an outer cover of an esoteric concoction without any reference to the true eternal aspect of transcendental nontransformable and imperishable manifestation of the immanent. The hymns have also dealt with different partial aspects of the personality of the Absolute who is quite isolated from the conception of the enjoyers of this phenomenal world.

A very close attention and a comparative study of all prevailing thoughts and conceptions will relieve and enlighten all—be he a materialist, a downright atheist, an agnostic, a sceptic, a naturalist, a pantheist or a panantheist—busy with their knowledge of three dimensions only by their speculative exertions.

This booklet is only the fifth chapter of the Hymns of Brahmā which were recorded in a hundred chapters. The Supreme Lord Çré Caitanya picked up this chapter from the temple of Ādi-keçava at Tiruvattar, a village lying under the government of Travancore, for the assurance of all God-loving, and especially Kåñëa-loving, people in this conditioned jurisdiction. This booklet can easily be compared with another book which passes by the name of Çrémad-Bhāgavatam. Though it has got a reference in the pantheon of Purāëas, the Bhāgavatam corroborates the same idea of this Paicarātra.

The devotees should consider that these two books tend to the identical Kåñëa who is the fountainhead of all transcendental and mundane entities and has a manifestive exhibition of the plenary variegatedness.

Aspersions of calumny are restricted in the limited world, whereas transcendence cannot admit such angularities being an angle of 180 degrees or void of any angular discrepancies.

The publisher is carried away to the realm of gratitude when his stores of publication are scrutinized. Öhäkura Bhaktivinoda has given an elucidatory purport of the conception of the most sublime fountainhead of all entities in Bengali, and one of his devout followers has rendered that

into English for propagatory purpose. The purports and the translations are traced to the backgrounds of the writings of Çréla Jéva Gosvämé, a contemporary follower of the Supreme Lord Çré Kåñëa Caitanya. The emotional aspirations will find fair play in perusing the texts of this brochure by one and all who have any interest in pure theistic achievements. The materialistic inspection often goes on to say that the provincial conception of theism has made the depicting of transcendental unity into diverse face quite opposed to the ethical consideration of the limited region. But we differ from such erroneous considerations when we get a prospective view of the manifested transcendental unity eliminating all historicities and allegorical enterprises. All our enjoying mood should have a different direction when we take into account the transcendental entity who has obsessed all frailties and limitations of nature. So we solicit the happier mood of the scrutinizers to pay special attention to the importance of manifestive transcendence in Kåñëa.

It was found necessary to publish this small book for the use of English-knowing people who are interested in the acme of transcendental truths in their manifestive phases. The theme delineated in the texts of this book is quite different from the ordinary heaps of poetical mundane literature, as they are confined to our limited aspiration of senses. The book was found in the South some four centuries ago and it is again brought into light in the very same country after a long time, just like the worshiping of the Goddess Ganges by the offering of her own water.

Siddhānta Sarasvaté

Shree Gaudiya Math,

Calcutta, the 1st August, 1932.

Bs 5

Brahma-saàhitä

Bs 5.1

TEXT 1

TEXT

écvaraù paramaù kãñëaù

sac-cid-änanda-vigrahaù

anädir ädir govindaù

sarva-käraëa-käraëam

SYNONYMS

écvaraù—the controller; paramaù—supreme; kãñëaù—Lord Kãñëa; sat—comprising eternal existence; cit—absolute knowledge; änanda—and absolute bliss; vigrahaù—whose form; anädiù—without beginning; ädiù—the origin; govindaù—Lord Govinda; sarva-käraëa-käraëam—the cause of all causes.

TRANSLATION

Kãñëa who is known as Govinda is the Supreme Godhead. He has an eternal blissful spiritual body. He is the origin of all. He has no other origin and He is the prime cause of all causes.

PURPORT

Kãñëa is the exalted Supreme entity having His eternal name, eternal form, eternal attribution and eternal pastimes. The very name “Kãñëa” implies His love-attracting designation, expressing by His eternal nomenclature the acme of entity. His eternal beautiful heavenly blue-tinged body glowing with the intensity of ever-existing knowledge has a flute in both His hands. As His inconceivable spiritual energy is all-extending, still He maintains His all-charming medium size by His qualifying spiritual instrumentals. His all-accommodating supreme subjectivity is nicely manifested in His eternal form. The concentrated all-time presence,

uncovered knowledge and inebriating felicity have their beauty in Him. The mundane manifestive portion of His own Self is known as all-pervading Paramātmā, Ēçvara (Superior Lord) or Viñëu (All-fostering). Hence it is evident that Kåñëa is sole Supreme Godhead. His unrivaled or unique spiritual body of superexcellent charm is eternally unveiled with innumerable spiritual instrumentals (senses) and unreckonable attributes keeping their signifying location properly, adjusting at the same time by His inconceivable conciliative powers. This beautiful spiritual figure is identical with Kåñëa and the spiritual entity of Kåñëa is identical with His own figure.

The very intensely blended entity of eternal presence of felicitous cognition is the charming targeted holding or transcendental icon. It follows that the conception of the indistinguishable formless magnitude (Brahman) which is an indolent, lax, presentment of cognitive bliss, is merely a penumbra of intensely blended glow of the three concomitants, viz., the blissful, the substantive and the cognitive. This transcendental manifestive icon Kåñëa in His original face is primordial background of magnitudinal infinite Brahman and of the all-pervasive oversoul. Kåñëa as truly visioned in His variegated pastimes, such as owner of transcendental cows, chief of cowherds, consort of milk-maids, ruler of the terrestrial abode Gokula and object of worship by transcendental residents of Goloka beauties, is Govinda. He is the root cause of all causes who are the predominating and predominated agents of the universe. The glance of His projected fractional portion in the sacred originating water viz., the personal oversoul or Paramātmā, gives rise to a secondary potency—nature who creates this mundane universe. This oversoul's intermediate energy brings forth the individual souls analogously to the emanated rays of the sun.

This book is a treatise of Kåñëa; so the preamble is enacted by chanting His name in the beginning.

Bs 5.2

TEXT 2

TEXT

sahasra-patra-kamalaà

gokulākhyāà mahat padam

tat-karëikāraà tad-dhāma

tad-anantāàça-sambhavam

SYNONYMS

sahasra-patra—possessing a thousand petals; kamalam—a lotus; gokula-ākhyam—known as Gokula; mahat padam—the superexcellent station; tat—of that (lotus); karëikāram—the whorl; tat—of Him (Kåñëa); dhāma—the abode; tat—that (Gokula); ananta—of His infinitary aspect, Balarāma; aàça—from a part; sambhavam—produced.

TRANSLATION

[The spiritual place of transcendental pastimes of Kåñëa is portrayed in the second verse.] The superexcellent station of Kåñëa, which is known as Gokula, has thousands of petals and a corolla like that of a lotus sprouted from a part of His infinitary aspect, the whorl of the leaves being the actual abode of Kåñëa.

PURPORT

Gokula, like Goloka, is not a created mundane plane—unbounded character forms the display of His unlimited potency and His propagating manifestation. Baladeva is the mainstay of that energy. The transcendental entity of Baladeva has two aspects viz., infinite spiritual manifestation and infinite accommodating space for insentient gross things. The unquadrantal delineation of material universe will be dealt with in the proper place. The triquadrantal extensions of the transcendental infinitary field of the almighty, unlamenting, nonperishing and nonapprehending unlimited situations of halo which are fully spiritual majestic foliation. This very majestic extension portrays the manifested lofty rich feature of the vaster unlimited region or greater atmosphere which has its resplendent

location wholly beyond the realm of mundane nature, on the further shore of Virajā surrounded by the halo of Brahman or indistinguishable entity. This majestic power of unlimited spirit emanates on the upper portion of the luminous sphere into the most charming Gokula or eternally existing Goloka, exceedingly beautified by the assorted display of effulgence. Some designate this region as the abode of the Supreme Nārāyaṇa, or the original fountainhead. Hence Gokula, which is identical with Goloka, is the supreme plane. The same sphere shines as Goloka and Gokula respectively by its upper or transcendental and lower or mundane situation.

Ṣré Sanātana Gosvāmé has told us as follows in his Bāhad-bhāgavatāmāta which embodies the final essence of all the books of instructions: “He displays His pastimes here in this land as He is used to do in Goloka. The difference between the two planes lies only in their locations as high and low; that is, in other words, Kāṇḍa plays exactly the same part in Goloka as He exhibits on the mundane plane of Gokula. There is practically no difference between Gokula and Goloka save that this what exists in the shape of Goloka in the upper region is the same as Gokula on the mundane plane when Kāṇḍa showed His various activity there. Ṣré Jéva Gosvāmé has also inculcated the same in the Bhagavat-sandarbhā of his ‘Six Treatises.’ ” To ascertain the plane of Goloka—Vāṇḍāvāna is the eternal abode of Kāṇḍa and Goloka and Vāṇḍāvāna are identically one, and though both are identical, yet Kāṇḍa’s inconceivable energy has made Goloka the acme of this spiritual kingdom and Gokula of Mathurā province forming a part of the mundane plane which is also a manifestation of triquadrantal vibhūti (conducting majesty). Poor human understanding cannot possibly make out how the extensive triquadrantal, which is beyond human comprehension, can be accommodated in the limited nether material universe of a uniuadrantal disclosure. Gokula is a spiritual plane, hence his condescended position in the region of material space, time, etc., is in no way restricted but unlimitedly manifested with his full boundless propriety. But conditioned souls are apt to assert a material conception in regard to Gokula by their miserable senses so as to bring him below the level of their intellect. Though the eye of an observer is impeded by a cloud when gazing at the sun and though the tiny cloud can never really cover the sun, still the clouded vision apparently observes the sun as covered by the cloud. In just the same way the conditioned souls with their obscured intelligence,

senses and decisions, accept Gokula as a piece of measurable land. We can see Gokula from Goloka which is eternal. This is also a mystery. The attainment of final beatitude is the success in attaining one's eternal self. The success in identifying the true self is finally achieved when the screen of gross and subtle coils of conditioned souls is removed by the sweet will of Kåñëa. However, the idea of Goloka is seen to differ from Gokula till the success in unalloyed devotion is achieved. The transcendental plane of infinite spiritual manifestation having thousands of petals and corolla like those of the lotus, is Gokula, the eternal abode of Kåñëa.

Bs 5.3

TEXT 3

TEXT

karëikäraà mahad yantraà

ñaö-koëaà vajra-kélakam

ñaò-aìga-ñaö-padé-sthänaà

prakåtyä puruñëëa ca

premānanda-mahānanda-

rasenāvasthitaà hi yat

jyoté-rüpeëa manunä

kāma-béjena saìgatam

SYNONYMS

karëikāram—the whorl; mahat—great; yantram—figure; ñaö-koëam—a hexagon; vajra—like a diamond; kélakam—the central support; ñaö-aìga-ñaö-padé—of the eighteen-syllable mantra with sixfold divisions;

sthānam—the place of manifestation; prakātyā—along with the predominated aspect of the Absolute; puruṇēēa—along with the predominating aspect of the Absolute; ca—also; prema-ānanda—of the bliss of love of God; mahā-ānanda—of the great transcendental jubilations; rasena—with the rasa (mellow); avasthitam—situated; hi—certainly; yat—which; jyotiù-rūpeēa—transcendental; manunā—with the mantra; kāma-béjena—with the kāma-béja (kléà); saìgatam—joined.

TRANSLATION

The whorl of that transcendental lotus is the realm wherein dwells Kāñēa. It is a hexagonal figure, the abode of the indwelling predominated and predominating aspect of the Absolute. Like a diamond the central supporting figure of self-luminous Kāñēa stands as the transcendental source of all potencies. The holy name consisting of eighteen transcendental letters is manifested in a hexagonal figure with sixfold divisions.

PURPORT

The transcendental pastimes of Kāñēa are twofold, viz., manifested and nonmanifested. The pastimes in Vāndāvana visible to mortal eyes are the manifestive lélä of Çré Kāñēa, and that which is not so visible, is nonmanifestive lélä of Kāñēa. The nonmanifestive lélä is always visible in Goloka and the same is visible to human eyes in Gokula, if Kāñēa so desires. In his Kāñēa-sandarbha Çré Jéva Gosvāmé Prabhu says, “Nonmanifestive pastimes are expressed in manifestive kãñēa-lélä. and goloka-lélä is the nonmanifestive pastimes of Kāñēa visualized from the mundane plane.” This is also corroborated by Çré Rūpa in his Bhāgavatāmāta. The progressive transcendental manifestation of Gokula is Goloka. So Goloka is the selfsame majestic manifestation of Gokula. The eternal pastimes of Çré Kāñēa, although not visible in Gokula, are eternally manifested in Goloka. Goloka is the transcendental majestic manifestation of Gokula. The manifestations of the nonmanifestive pastimes of Kāñēa with regard to the conditioned souls, are twofold, viz., (1) worship through the channel of the mantras (inaudibly recited, liberating, self-dedicatory. transcendental sounds), (2) spontaneous outflow of heart’s spiritual love for Kāñēa. Çré

Jéva Gosvämé has said that worship through the mantra is possible permanently in the proper place, when confined to one pastime. This meditative manifestation of Goloka is the pastime attended with the worship of Kåñëa through the mantra. Again, the pastimes that are performed in different planes and in different moods, are autocratic in diverse ways; hence svä-rasiké, i.e., spontaneous, outflow of heart's spiritual love for Kåñëa. This çloka conveys a twofold meaning. One meaning is that in the pastime attended with worship through the mantra consisting of eighteen transcendental letters, transcendental words contained in the said mantra being differently placed make a manifestation of only one lélä of Çré Kåñëa. As for example kléà kåñëäya govindäya gopéjana-vallabhäya svähä—this is a hexagonal mantra consisting of six transcendental words, viz., (1) kåñëäya, (2) govindäya, (3) gopéjana, (4) vallabhäya, (5) svä, (6) hä. These six transcendental words, when placed juxtapositionally, indicate the mantra.

The hexagonal great transcendental machinery is in this wise. The principal seed, i.e. kléà, is situated in the instrument as the central pivot. Anybody with an impression of such an instrument in his mind and concentrating his thought on such spiritual entities, can attain, like Candradhvaja, to the knowledge of the cognitive principle. The word svä indicates kñetrajña i.e., one who is conversant with one's inner self, and the word hä indicates the transcendental nature. This meaning of the mantra has also been corroborated by Çré Hari-bhakti-viläsa. The general meaning is this that one who is desirous of entering into the esoteric pastimes of Kåñëa will have to practice His transcendental service along with the culture of the devotional knowledge relative to Him. (1) kåñëa-svarüpa—the proper Self of Kåñëa; (2) kåñëasya cin-maya-vraja-lélä-viläsa-svarüpa—the true nature of Kåñëa's transcendental pastimes in Vraja; (3) tat-parikara-gopéjana-svarüpa—the true nature of His spiritual associates in Vraja, viz., the spiritual milkmen and the milkmaids; (4) tad-vallabha—the true nature of self-surrender to Kåñëa in the footsteps of the spiritual milkmaids of Vraja; (5) çuddha-jévasya cid-(jñäna)-svarüpa—the true nature of the spiritual knowledge of the unalloyed individual soul; (6) cit-prakåtir arthät kåñëa-sevā-svabhāva—the true nature of transcendental service to Kåñëa is this that the esoteric relation is established on the awakening of one's pure cognition. The meaning is that rasa is only the transcendental

service of the central refuge Çré Kåñëa, as predominating aspect of the Absolute, by one's ego as the spiritual maid of the predominated moiety of the absolute integer, attended with pure devotion in the shape of one's entire self-surrender. The pastime in Goloka or in Gokula during the stage of devotional progress, is the meditative worship through the mantra, and during the stage of perfection the pastimes manifest themselves as the unrestrained transcendental jubilations. This is the real aspect of Goloka or Gokula, which will be made more explicit in due course. The meaning of the words jyoté-rüpeëa manunä [Bs 5.3] is that the transcendental meaning is expressed in the mantra by means of which, on transcendental desire of love for Kåñëa and the service of Kåñëa being added, one is established in the eternal love of Kåñëa. Such eternal pastimes are eternally manifested in Goloka.

Bs 5.4

TEXT 4

TEXT

tat-kiiṅjalkaà tad-aàçänää

tat-paträëi çriyäm api

SYNONYMS

tat—of that (lotus); kiiṅjalkam—the petals; tat-aàçänäm—of His (Kåñëa's) fragmental portions; tat—of that (lotus); paträëi—the leaves; çriyäm—of the gopés (headed by Çrématé Rādhārāëé); api—also.

TRANSLATION

The whorl of that eternal realm Gokula is the hexagonal abode of Kåñëa. Its petals are the abodes of gopés who are part and parcel of Kåñëa to whom they are most lovingly devoted and are similar in essence. The petals shine beautifully like so many walls. The extended leaves of that lotus are the gardenlike dhāma, i.e. spiritual abode of Çré Rādhikā, the most beloved

of Kåñëa.

PURPORT

The transcendental Gokula is shaped like the lotus. The eternal world is like a hexagonal figure; in that the entities Çré Rādhā-Kāñëa, appearing in the form of a mantra consisting of eighteen transcendental letters, are centered. The propagating manifestations emanating from the cit potency are present there with the said entities as the center. Çré Rādhā-Kāñëa is the primary cause or the seed Himself. Gopāla-tāpané says, “Oākāra” signifies the All-Powerful Gopāla and His potency; and “klèa” is the same as oākāra. Hence kāma-béja or the primary cause of all-love, is connotative of the entities Çré Rādhā-Kāñëa.

Bs 5.5

TEXT 5

TEXT

catur-asraà tat-paritaù

çvetadvépäkhyam adbhutam

catur-asraà catur-mürteç

catur-dhäma catuñ-kātam

caturbhiù puruñārthaiç ca

caturbhir hetubhir vātam

çülair daçabhir ānaddham

ürdhvādho dig-vidikñv api

añöabhir nidhibhir juñöam

añöabhiù siddhibhis tathä

manu-rüpaiç ca daçabhir

dik-pälaiù parito vâtam

çyämair gauraiç ca raktaiç ca

çuklaiç ca pärñadarñabhaiù

çobhitaà çaktibhis täbhir

adbhutäbhiù samantataù

SYNONYMS

catuù-asraà—quadrangular place; tat—that (Gokula); paritaù—surrounding; çveta-dvépa—Çvetadvépa (the white island); äkhyam—named; adbham—mysterious; catuù-asram—quadrangular; catuù-mürteù—of the four primary expansions (Väsudeva, Saìkarñaëa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha); catuù-dhäma—consisting of four abodes; catuù-kâtam—divided into four parts; caturbhiù—by the four; puruñä-arthaiù—human requirements; ca—and; caturbhiù—by the four; hetubhiù—causes, or bases of achievement; vâtam—enveloped; çülaiù—with tridents; daçabhiù—ten; änaddham—fixed; ürdhva-adhaù—upwards and downwards (the zenith and nadir); dik—(in) the directions (north, south, east, and west); vidikñu—and in the intermediate directions (northeast, southeast, southwest, and northwest); api—also; añöabhiù—with the eight; nidhibhiù—jewels; juñöam—endowed; añöabhiù—with the eight; siddhibhiù—mystic perfections (aëimä, laghimä, präpti, präkämya, mahimä, éçitva, vaçitva, and kämävasäyitä); tathä—also; manu-rüpaiù—in the form of mantras; ca—and; daçabhiù—by ten; dik-pälaiù—protectors of the directions; paritaù—all around; vâtam—surrounded; çyämaiù—blue; gauraiù—yellow; ca—and; raktaiù—red; ca—and; çuklaiù—white; ca—also; pärñada-añabhaiù—with the topmost associates; çobhitam—shining; çaktibhiù—with potencies; täbhiù—those; adbhutäbhiù—extraordinary; samantataù—on all sides.

TRANSLATION

[The surrounding external plane of Gokula is described in this verse.] There is a mysterious quadrangular place named Çvetadvépa surrounding the outskirts of Gokula. Çvetadvépa is divided into four parts on all sides. The abode of Väsudeva, Saïkarñaëa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha are separately located in each of these four parts. These four divided abodes are enveloped by the fourfold human requirements such as piety, wealth, passion and liberation, as also by the four Vedas, viz., Åg, Säma, Yajur and Atharva, which deal with the mantra and which are the bases of achievements of the fourfold mundane requirements. Ten tridents are fixed in the ten directions, including the zenith and nadir. The eight directions are decorated with the eight jewels of Mahäpadma, Padma, Çaikha, Makara, Kacchapa, Mukunda, Kunda, and Néla. There are ten protectors [dik-pälas] of the ten directions in the form of mantra. The associates of the hues of blue, yellow, red and white and the extraordinary potencies bearing the names of Vimala, etc., shine on all sides.

PURPORT

Primarily Gokula is the seat of transcendental love and devotion. Hence Yamunä, Çré Govardhana, Çré Rädhä-kuëòä, etc., of the terrestrial Vraja-maëòäla lie within Gokula. Again, all the majesties of Vaikuëöha are manifested there extending in all directions. The pastimes of the four propagating manifestations are all there in their proper places. The paravyoma Vaikuëöha has got its extension from the display of the four propagating manifestations. Salvation as of Vaikuëöha, and piety, wealth and passion pertaining to worldly people, are in the proper places in Gokula as their original seed, i.e., primary cause. The Vedas also are engaged in singing the song of the Lord of Gokula. There are ten tridents in ten directions to prevent and disappoint those who are aspirants for having an entrance into Goloka through meditations without the grace of Kåñëa. Self-conceited people who try to reach this region through the paths of yoga (meditation) and jïäna (empiric knowledge) are baffled in their attempts, being pierced by the ten tridents. Self-annihilation has its excellence in Brahma-dhäma which represents the outside covering of Goloka in the shape of tridents. Çüla means a trident; the mundane threefold attributes

and the threefold divisions of time represent the trident. Añöäiga-yogis i.e. ascetics who practice the eightfold yoga, are the nondifferentiative liberationists who, trying to approach in the direction of Goloka, fall headlong into the pits of disappointment by being pierced and cut asunder by these tridents placed in ten directions. Those who proceed towards the direction of Goloka through the channel of devotion alloyed with majestic ideas, are fascinated with the charms of Vaikuëöha which is the outer covering plane of Çré Goloka, at the sight of the eight perfections, viz., aëimä, etc., and majesties like mahäpadma, etc. Those who are less forward in their intelligence relapse to the sevenfold world falling under the control of the ten protectors (of the ten directions) in the guise of mantras. In this wise, Goloka has become unknowable and inaccessible. It is only the divine selves of Godhead, the propounders of the divine dispensations for the different ages, who are always forward there to favor the approaching devotees who seek entry into the realm of Goloka through the channel of pure devotional love. These divine forms of Godhead are surrounded there with attendants of their respective natures. Çvetadvépa in Goloka is their place of abode. Hence Çréla Öhäkura Vändävana the manifest Vyäsa of caitanya-lélä, has described the village of Navadvépa as bearing the name of Çvetadvépa. In this Çvetadvépa the concluding portions of the pastimes of Gokula exist eternally as the pastimes of Navadvépa. Hence the region of Navadvépa, Vraja and the realm of Goloka are one and the same indivisible entity; the difference only lies in the manifestations of the infinite variety of sentiments, corresponding to the diverse nature of their devotional love. There is in this a most hidden principle which only the greatest souls who are possessed of the highest transcendental love, are enabled to realize by the direct grace of Kåñëa. The truth is as follows: In this mundane world there are fourteen spheres disposed in the graded order of high and low. Persons living with wives and children hankering for the pleasure-giving effect of their fruitive actions, move up and down within the limits of the three worlds of Bhüù, Bhuvaù and Svaù. Brahmacärés of great austerities, ascetics and persons addicted to hypothetical truth, persons of a neutral disposition adopting nonfruitive works by an aptitude which seeks to be free from all mundane desires, move up and down within the limits of the worlds of Mahaù, Janaù, Tapaù and Satya. Above these worlds lies the abode of four-headed Brahmä, above which lies the unlimited realm of Vaikuëöha of Viñëu, Kñérodakaçäyë, lying in the ocean of milk.

paramahansa-sannyāsés and the demons killed by Çré Hari, by crossing the Virajā, i.e., by passing beyond the fourteen worlds, enter into the luminous realm of Brahman and attain to nirvāëa in the form of temporary abeyance of the temporal ego. But the devotee actuated by knowledge (jñāna-bhakta), the devotee actuated by the pure devotional aptitude (çuddha-bhakta), the devotee imbued with loving devotion (prema-bhakta), the devotee actuated by pure love (premapara-bhakta), and the devotee impelled by overwhelming love (premätura-bhakta), who serve the majesty of Godhead, have their locations in Vaikuëöha, i.e., the transcendental realm of Çré Nārāyaëa.

The devotees who are imbued with all-love and who walk in the footsteps of the spiritual maids of Vraja, alone attain to the realm of Goloka. The different locations of the devotees in Goloka according to the respective differences in the nature of their rasa, i.e., mellow quality, are settled by the inconceivable power of Kāñëa. The pure devotees following the devotees of Vraja and those following the pure devotees of Navadvépa are located in the realm of Kāñëa and Gaura respectively. The identical devotees of Vraja and Navadvépa simultaneously attain to the pleasures of service in the realm of Kāñëa and Gaura. Çré Jéva Gosvāmé writes in his work Gopāla-campü that “the supreme transcendental realm is called Goloka being the abode of go, transcendental cows, and gopa, transcendental cowherds. This is the seat of the rasa pastimes of the absolute Çré Kāñëa. Again the realm is called Çvetadvépa owing to the realization of some of the rasas which are the inconceivable manifestation derived from the untouched purity of that supreme realm. The twofold entities of the supreme Goloka and the supreme Çvetadvépa are indivisibly the realm of Goloka.” The gist of the whole matter is this—Goloka as Çvetadvépa is eternally manifest because the pleasures of enjoyment of the rasa could not be had in its entirety in the pastimes of Kāñëa in Vraja. He accepts the emotion and effulgence of His predominated moiety. Çré Rādhikā, and makes an eternal pastime for the enjoyment of kāñëa-rasa there. Çré Kāñëacandra coveting to taste the following pleasures, viz., to realize (1) the nature of the greatness of love of Çré Rādhā; (2) the nature of the wonderful sweetness of His love of which Çré Rādhikā has got the taste; (3) the nature of the exquisite joy that accrues to Çré Rādhā by Her realization of the sweetness of His love, took His birth, like the moon, in the

ocean of the womb of Çré Çacé-devé. The esoteric desire of Çré Jéva Gosvámé Prabhu is herein made manifest. In the Veda it is also said, “Let me tell you the mystery. In Navadvépa, the identical realm of Goloka, on the bank of the Ganges, Gauracandra who is Govinda, the entity of pure cognition, who has two hands, who is the soul of all souls, who has the supreme great personality as the great meditative sannyāsin and who is beyond the threefold mundane attributes, makes the process of pure unalloyed devotion manifest in this mundane world. He is sole Godhead. He is the source of all forms, the Supreme Soul and is Godhead manifesting Himself in yellow, red, blue and white colors. He is the direct entity of pure cognition full of the spiritual (cit) potency. He is the figure of the devotee. He is the bestower of devotion and cognizable by devotion alone. The selfsame Gauracandra, who is no other than Kåñëa Himself, in order to taste the rasa of the pastimes of Rādhā-Kåñëa in Goloka, is manifest in the eternal realm of Navadvépa identical with Goloka.” This is also clear from the Vedic declarations, viz., āsan varëäs trayaù, kåñëa-varëaà tviñākåñëam, yathā paçyaù paçyati rukma-varëam, mahān prabhur vai and various other statements of the theistic scriptures. Just as Çré Kåñëa had His birth in the mundane Gokula through the agency of Yogamāyā who is the primal energy of the Supreme Lord, so with her help He manifests the lélä of His birth in the womb of Çacé-devé in Navadvépa on this mundane plane. These are the absolute truths of spiritual science and not the outcome of imaginary speculation under the thraldom of the deluding energy of Godhead.

Bs 5.6

TEXT 6

TEXT

evaà jyotir-mayo devaù

sad-ānandaù parāt paraù

ātmārāmasya tasyāsti

prakātyā na samāgamaù

SYNONYMS

evam—thus; jyotiù-mayaù—transcendental; devaù—the Lord; sat-
ānandaù—the own Self of eternal ecstasies; parāt paraù—the superior of
all superiors; ātma-ārāmasya—engaged in the enjoyments of the
transcendental realm; tasya—of Him; asti—there is; prakātyā—with the
mundane potency; na—not; samāgamaù—association.

TRANSLATION

The Lord of Gokula is the transcendental Supreme Godhead, the own
Self of eternal ecstasies. He is the superior of all superiors and is busily
engaged in the enjoyments of the transcendental realm and has no
association with His mundane potency.

PURPORT

The sole potency of Kāñëa which is spiritual, functioning as Kāñëa's own
proper power, has manifested His pastimes of Goloka or Gokula. By her
grace individual souls who are constituents of the marginal potency can
have admission into even those pastimes. The deluding energy who is of
the nature of the perverted reflection of the spiritual (cit) potency. has got
her location on the other side of the river Virajā, which surrounds the
Brahma-dhāma forming the boundary of Mahā-Vaikuëöha as the outer
envelope of Goloka. The position of Goloka being absolutely unalloyed with
the mundane, deluding energy. far from having any association with Kāñëa,
feels ashamed to appear before His view.

Bs 5.7

TEXT 7

TEXT

māyayāramamāëasya

na viyogas tayä saha

ätmanä ramayä reme

tyakta-kälaà sisåkñayä

SYNONYMS

mäyayä—with the illusory energy; aramamäëasya—of Him, who never consorts; na—not; viyogaù—complete separation; tayä—her; saha—from; ätmanä—with His own; ramayä—spiritual potency, Ramä; reme—consorts; tyakta-kälam—by casting His glance in the shape of sending His time energy; sisåkñayä—with the desire to create.

TRANSLATION

Kåñëa never consorts with His illusory energy. Still her connection is not entirely cut off from the Absolute Truth. When He intends to create the material world the amorous pastime, in which He engages by consorting with His own spiritual [cit] potency Ramä by casting His glance at the deluding energy in the shape of sending His time energy, is an auxiliary activity.

PURPORT

The illusory energy has no direct contact with Kåñëa, but has got indirect contact. Viñëu the prime cause, lying in the Causal Ocean, the plenary portion of Mahä-Saïkarñaëa who has His scat in Mahä-Vaikuëöha the sphere of Kåñëa's own extended transcendental pastimes, casts His glance towards the deluding energy. Even in casting His glance He has no contact with the deluding energy because the spiritual (cit) potency Ramä then carries the function of His glance as His unpolluted ever-submissive potency. The deluding energy as the maidservant of the spiritual (cit) potency Ramä, serves the manifested plenary portion of Godhead consorted with Ramä, the time energy representing the force of activity and instrumentality of Ramä; hence there is found the process of masculinity or the creative force.

Bs 5.8

TEXT 8

TEXT

niyatiù sä ramä devi

tat-priyā tad-vaçaà tadä

tal-liṅgaà bhagavān çambhur

jyoti-rüpaù sanātanaù

yä yoniù säparä çaktiù

kämo béjaà mahad dhareù

SYNONYMS

niyatiù—the regulator; sä—she; ramä—the spiritual potency; devi—the goddess; tat—of Him; priyā—beloved; tat—of Him; vaçam—under the control; tadä—then (at the time of creation); tat—of Him; liṅgam—the masculine symbol, or manifested emblem; bhagavān—possessing opulences; çambhuù—Çambhu; jyotiù-rüpaù—halo; sanātanaù—eternal; yä—which; yoniù—the symbol of mundane feminine productivity; sa—that; aparä—nonabsolute; çaktiù—potency; kämaù—the desire; béjam—the seed; mahat—the faculty of perverted cognition; hareù—of the Supreme Lord.

TRANSLATION

[The secondary process of association with Mäyā is described.] Ramādevé, the spiritual [cit] potency, beloved consort of the Supreme Lord, is the regulatrix of all entities. The divine plenary portion of Kāñëa creates the mundane world. At creation there appears a divine halo of the nature of His own subjective portion [sväàça]. This halo is divine Çambhu, the masculine symbol or manifested emblem of the Supreme Lord. This halo is the dim twilight reflection of the supreme eternal effulgence. This

masculine symbol is the subjective portion of divinity who functions as progenitor of the mundane world, subject to the supreme regulatrix [niyati]. The conceiving potency in regard to mundane creation makes her appearance out of the supreme regulatrix. She is Māyā, the limited, nonabsolute [aparā] potency, the symbol of mundane feminine productivity. The intercourse of these two brings forth the faculty of perverted cognition, the reflection of the seed of the procreative desire of the Supreme Lord.

PURPORT

Saṅkarṣaṇa possessed of creative desire is the subjective portion of Kṛṣṇa taking the initiative in bringing about the birth of the mundane world. Lying in the causal water as the primal puruṣa-avatāra He casts His glance towards Māyā (the limited potency). Such glance is the efficient cause of the mundane creation. Ćambhu the symbol of masculine mundane procreation is the dim halo of this reflected effulgence. It is this symbol which is applied to the organ of generation of Māyā, the shadow of Rāmā or the divine potency. The first phase of the appearance of the mundane desire created by Mahā-Viṣṇu is called the seminal principle of mahat or the perverted cognitive faculty. It is this which is identical with the mental principle ripe for procreative activity. The conception underlying it is that it is the will of the puruṣa who creates by using the efficient and material principles. Efficiency is Māyā or the productive feminine organ. The material principle is Ćambhu or the procreative masculine organ. Mahā-Viṣṇu is puruṣa or the dominating divine person wielding the will. Pradhāna or the substantive principle in the shape of mundane entities, is the material principle. Nature embodying the accommodating principle (ādhāra), is Māyā. The principle of embodied will bringing about the intercourse of the two, is the dominating divine person (puruṣa), subjective portion of Kṛṣṇa, the manifestor of the mundane world. All of these three are creators. The seed of amorous creative desire in Goloka, is the embodiment of pure cognition. The seed of sex desire to be found in this mundane world, is that of Kālā, etc., who are the shadows of the divine potency. The former, although it is the prototype of the latter, is located very far from it. The seed of the mundane sex desire is the perverted reflection in this mundane world of the seed of the original creative desire.

The process of the appearance of Çambhu is recorded in the tenth and fifteenth çloka.

Bs 5.9

TEXT 9

TEXT

liiga-yony-ätmikä jätä

imä mäheçvaré-prajāu

SYNONYMS

liiga—of the mundane masculine generative organs; yoni—and of the mundane feminine generative organs; ätmikäu—as the embodiment; jätäu—born; imäu—these; mäheçvaré—of the consort of the great lord of this mundane world; prajāu—the offspring.

TRANSLATION

All offspring of the consort of the great lord [Maheçvara] of this mundane world are of the nature of the embodiment of the mundane masculine and feminine generative organs.

PURPORT

The full quadrantal extension of the Supreme Lord, is His majesty. Of this the triquadrantal extensions of unlamenting, nonperishing and nonapprehending situations constitute the majesties of the realms of Vaikuëöha and Goloka, etc. In this temporal realm of Mäyā devas and men, etc.—all these together with all mundane worlds—are the great majesties of the limited potency. All these entities are embodiments of the masculine and feminine organs of generation by the distinction of efficient and material causal principles; or, in other words, they are produced by the process of sexual intercourse between the male and female organs of

generation. All the information that has been accumulated by the agency of the sciences of this world, possesses this nature of sexual co-union. Trees, plants and even all insentient entities are embodiments of the co-union of male and female. The feature that is of special significance is that although such expressions as “the generative organs of male and female” are indecorous yet in scientific literature these words, expressing the above-mentioned principles, are exceedingly wholesome and productive of abiding value. Indecorum is merely an entity pertaining to the external custom of society. But science, and specially the highest science, cannot destroy the true entity by deference to social custom. Wherefore, in order to demonstrate the seed of mundane sex desire, the basic principle of this phenomenal world, the use of those identical words is indispensable. By the use of all these words only the masculine energy or the predominating active potency. and female energy or the predominated active potency. are to be understood.

Bs 5.10

TEXT 10

TEXT

çaktimān puruṇḥaṇḥ so 'yaṇḥ

liṅga-rūpé maheçvaraṇḥ

tasminn ävirabhül liṅge

mahä-viñḇeur jagat-patiṇḥ

SYNONYMS

çaktimān- joined to his female consort; puruṇḥaṇḥ—person; saṇḥ—he; ayam—this; liṅga-rūpé—in the form of the male generating organ; mahä-éçvaraṇḥ—Çambhu, the lord of this mundane world; tasmin—in that; ävirabhüt—manifested; liṅge—in the manifested emblem; mahä-viñḇeuṇḥ—Mahä-Viñḇeu; jagat-patiṇḥ—the Lord of the world.

TRANSLATION

The person embodying the material causal principle, viz., the great lord of this mundane world [Maheçvara] Çamhhu, in the form of the male generating organ, is joined to his female consort the limited energy [Mâyä] as the efficient causal principle. The Lord of the world Mahä-Viñëu is manifest in him by His subjective portion in the form of His glance.

PURPORT

In the transcendental atmosphere (para-vyoma), where spiritual majesty preponderates, there is present Çré Nārāyaëa who is not different from Kāñëa. Mahä-Saïkarñaëa, subjective plenary facsimile of the extended personality of Çré Nārāyaëa, is also the divine plenary portion of the propagatory embodiment of Çré Kāñëa. By the power of His spiritual energy a plenary subjective portion of Him, eternally reposing in the neutral stream of Virajā forming the boundary between the spiritual and mundane realms, casts His glance, at creation, unto the limited shadow potency. Mâyä, who is located far away from Himself. Thereupon Çambhu, lord of pradhāna embodying the substantive principle of all material entities, who is the same as Rudra, the dim reflection of the Supreme Lord's own divine glance, consummates his intercourse with Mâyä, the efficient mundane causal principle. But he can do nothing independently of the energy of Mahä-Viñëu representing the direct spiritual power of Kāñëa. Therefore, the principle of mahat, or the perverted cognitive faculty, is produced only when the subjective plenary portion of Kāñëa, viz., the prime divine avatāra Mahä-Viñëu who is the subjective portion of Saïkarñaëa, Himself the subjective portion of Kāñëa, is propitious towards the active mutual endeavors of Mâyä, Çiva's consort (çakti), and pradhāna or the principle of substantive mundane causality. Agreeably to the initiative of Mahä-Viñëu the consort of Çiva creates successively the mundane ego (ahaikāra), the five mundane elements (bhūtas) viz., space etc., their attributes (tan-mātras) and the limited senses of the conditioned soul (jēva). The constituent particles, in the form of pencils of effulgence of Mahä-Viñëu, are manifest as the individual souls (jēvas). This will be elaborated in the sequel.

Bs 5.11

TEXT 11

TEXT

sahasra-çérñä puruñau

sahasräkñau sahasra-pät

sahasra-bähur viçvätmä

sahasräàçaù sahasra-süù

SYNONYMS

sahasra-çérñä—possessing thousands of heads; puruñau—Lord Mahä-Viñëu, the first puruñä-avatära; sahasra-akñau—possessing thousands of eyes; sahasra-pät—possessing thousands of legs; sahasra-bähuù—possessing thousands of arms; viçva-ätmä—the Supersoul of the universe; sahasra-aàçaù—the source of thousands of avatäras; sahasra-süù—the creator of thousands of individual souls.

TRANSLATION

The Lord of the mundane world, Mahä-Viñëu, possesses thousands of thousands of heads, eyes, hands. He is the source of thousands of thousands of avatäras in His thousands of thousands of subjective portions. He is the creator of thousands of thousands of individual souls.

PURPORT

Mahä-Viñëu, the object of worship of the hymns of all the Vedas, is possessed of an infinity of senses and potencies, and He is the prime avatära-puruñä, the source of all the avatäras.

Bs 5.12

TEXT 12

TEXT

nārāyaëaù sa bhagavän

äpas tasmät sanätanät

äviräsét käraëärëo

nidhiù saìkarñaëätmakaù

yoga-nidrää gatas tasmin

sahasräàçaù svayaà mahän

SYNONYMS

nārāyaëaù—named Nārāyaëa; saù—that; bhagavän—Supreme Personality of Godhead, Mahä-Viñëu; äpaù—water; tasmät—from that; sanätanät—eternal person; äviräsét—has sprung; käraëa-arëaù—the Causal Ocean; nidhiù—expanse of water; saìkarñaëa-ätmakaù—the subjective portion of Saìkarñaëa; yoga-nidräm gataù—in the state of deep sleep; tasmin—in that (water); sahasra-aàçaù—with thousands of portions; svayam—Himself; mahän—the Supreme Person.

TRANSLATION

The same Mahä-Viñëu is spoken of by the name of “Nārāyaëa” in this mundane world. From that eternal person has sprung the vast expanse of water of the spiritual Causal Ocean. The subjective portion of Saìkarñaëa who abides in paravyoma, the above supreme puruña with thousands of subjective portions, reposes in the state of divine sleep [yoga-nidrä] in the waters of the spiritual Causal Ocean.

PURPORT

Yoga-nidrā (divine sleep) is spoken of as ecstatic trance which is of the nature of the bliss of the true subjective personality. The above-mentioned Ramādevé is yoga-nidrā in the form of Yogamāyā.

Bs 5.13

TEXT 13

TEXT

tad-roma-bila jāleñu

béjaà saikarñāēasya ca

haimāny aēōāni jātāni

mahā-bhūtāvātāni tu

SYNONYMS

tat—of Him (Mahā-Viñēu); roma-bila-jāleñu—in the pores of the skin; béjam—the seeds; saikarñāēasya—of Saikarñāēā; ca—and; haimāni—golden; aēōāni—eggs or sperms; jāta-ni—born; mahā-bhūta—by the five great elements; āvātāni—covered; tu—certainly.

TRANSLATION

The spiritual seeds of Saikarñāēā existing in the pores of skin of Mahā-Viñēu, are born as so many golden sperms. These sperms are covered with five great elements.

PURPORT

The prime divine avatāra lying in the spiritual Causal Ocean is such a great affair that in the pores of His divine form spring up myriads of seeds of the universes. Those series of universes are the perverted reflections of the infinite transcendental region. As long as they remain embedded in His

divine form they embody the principle of spiritual reflection having the form of golden eggs. Nevertheless by the creative desire of Mahā-Viññeu the minute particles of the great elements, which are constituents of the mundane efficient and material causal principles, envelop them. When those golden sperms, coming out with the exhalation of Mahā-Viññeu, enter into the unlimited accommodating chamber of the limited potency (Māyā) they become enlarged by the nonconglomerate great elements.

Bs 5.14

TEXT 14

TEXT

praty-aëòam evam ekääçäd

ekääçäd viçati svayam

sahasra-mürdhä viçvātmā

mahā-viññeuñ sanātanañ

SYNONYMS

prati—each; aëòam—egglike universe; evam—thus; eka-aàçät eka-aàçät—as His own separate subjective portions; viçati—enters; svayam—personally; sahasra-mürdhä—possessing thousands of heads; viçva-ātmā—the Supersoul of the universe; mahā-viññeuñ—Mahā-Viññeu; sanātanañ—eternal.

TRANSLATION

The same Mahā-Viññeu entered into each universe as His own separate subjective portions. The divine portions, that entered into each universe are possessed of His majestic extension, i.e., they are the eternal universal soul Mahā-Viññeu, possessing thousands of thousands of heads.

PURPORT

Mahā-Viñēu lying in the spiritual Causal Ocean is the subjective portion of Mahā-Saīkarṇāēa. He entered, as His own subjective portions, into those universes. These individual portions all represent the second divine puruṇa lying in the ocean of conception and is identical with Mahā-Viñēu in every respect. He is also spoken of as the divine guide, from within, of all souls.

Bs 5.15

TEXT 15

TEXT

vāmāḡād asājad viñēuà

dakṇiēāḡāt prajāpatim

jyotir-liḡa-mayaà çambhuà

kürca-deçäd aväsājat

SYNONYMS

vāma-aḡāt—from His left limb; asājat—He created; viñēum—Lord Viñēu; dakṇiēa-aḡāt—from His right limb; prajāpatim—Hiraēyagarbha Brahmā; jyotiù-liḡa—the divine masculine manifested halo; mayam—“comprising; çambhum—Çambhu; kürca-deçät—from the space between His two eyebrows; aväsājat—He created.

TRANSLATION

The same Mahā-Viñēu created Viñēu from His left limb, Brahmā, the first progenitor of beings, from His right limb and, from the space between His two eyebrows, Çambhu, the divine masculine manifested halo.

PURPORT

The divine puruṇa, lying in the ocean of milk, the same who is the regulator of all individual souls, is Çré Viñëu; and Hiraëyagarbha, the seminal principle, the portion of the Supreme Lord, is the prime progenitor who is different from the four-faced Brahmä. This same Hiraëyagarbha is the principle of seminal creating energy of every Brahmä belonging to each of the infinity of universes. The divine masculine manifested halo, Çambhu, is the plenary manifestation of his prototype Çambhu, the same as the primary divine masculine generative symbol Çambhu whose nature has already been described. Viñëu is the integral subjective portion of Mahä-Viñëu. Hence He is the great Lord of all the other lords. The progenitor (Brahmä) and Çambhu are the dislocated portions of Mahä-Viñëu. Hence they are gods with delegated functions. His own potency being on the left side of Godhead, Viñëu appears in the left limb of Mahä-Viñëu from the unalloyed essence of His spiritual (cit) potency. Viñëu, who is Godhead Himself, is the inner guiding oversoul of every individual soul. He is the Personality of Godhead described in the Vedas as being of the measure of a thumb. He is the nourisher. The karmés (elevationists) worship Him as Nārāyaëa, the Lord of sacrifices, and the yogés desire to merge their identities in Him as Paramätmä, by the process of their meditative trance.

Bs 5.16

TEXT 16

TEXT

ahaikärätmakaà viçvaà

tasmäd etad vyajäyata

SYNONYMS

ahaikära—the mundane egotistic principle; ätmakam—enshrining; viçvam—universe; tasmät—from that (Çambhu); etat—this; vyajäyata—has originated.

TRANSLATION

The function of Çambhu in relation to jévas is that this universe enshrining the mundane egotistic principle has originated from Çambhu.

PURPORT

The basic principle is the Supreme Lord Himself who is the embodiment of the principle of existence of all entities devoid of separating egotisms. In this mundane world the appearance of individual entities as separated egotistic symbols, is the limited perverted reflection of the unalloyed spiritual (cit) potency; and, as representing the primal masculine divine generative function Çambhu, it is united to the accommodating principle, viz., the mundane female organ which is the perverted reflection of the spiritual (cit) potency, Ramādevé. At this function Çambhu is nothing but the mere material causal principle embodying the extension in the shape of ingredient as matter. Again when in course of the progressive evolution of mundane creation each universe is manifested, then in the principle of Çambhu, born of the space between the two eyebrows of Viñëu, there appears the manifestation of the personality of Rudra; yet under all circumstances Çambhu fully enshrines the mundane egotistic principle. The innumerable jévas as spiritual particles emanating from the oversoul in the form of pencils of rays of effulgence, have no relation with the mundane world when they come to know themselves to be the eternal servants of the Supreme Lord. They are then incorporated into the realm of Vaikuëöha. But when they desire to lord it over Mäyä, forgetting their real identity. the egotistic principle Çambhu entering into their entities makes them identify themselves as separated enjoyers of mundane entities. Hence Çambhu is the primary principle of the egotistic mundane universe and of perverted egotism in jévas that identifies itself with their limited material bodies.

Bs 5.17

TEXT 17

TEXT

atha tais tri-vidhair veçair

léläm udvahataù kila

yoga-nidrä bhagavaté

tasya çrér iva saìgatä

SYNONYMS

atha—thereupon; taiù—with those; tri-vidhaiù—threefold; veçaiù—forms; léläm—pastimes; udvahataù—carrying on; kila—indeed; yoga-nidrä—Yoganidrä; bhagavaté—full of the ecstatic trance of eternal bliss; tasya—of Him; çrèù—the goddess of fortune; iva—like; saìgatä—consorted with.

TRANSLATION

Thereupon the same great personal Godhead, assuming the threefold forms of Viñëu, Prajäpati and Çambhu, entering into the mundane universe, plays the pastimes of preservation, creation and destruction of this world. This pastime is contained in the mundane world. Hence, it being perverted, the Supreme Lord, identical with Mahä-Viñëu, prefers to consort with the goddess Yoganidrä, the constituent of His own spiritual [cit] potency full of the ecstatic trance of eternal bliss appertaining to His own divine personality.

PURPORT

The dislocated portions of the Divinity. viz., Prajäpati and Çambhu, both identifying themselves as entities who are separate from the divine essence, sport with their respective nonspiritual (acit) consorts, viz., Sävitré-devé and Umä-devé, the perverted reflections of the spiritual (cit) potency. The Supreme Lord Viñëu is the only Lord of the spiritual (cit) potency. Ramä or Lakñmé.

Bs 5.18

TEXT 18

TEXT

sisākñäyää tato nābhes

tasya padmaà viniryayau

tan-nālaà hema-nalinaà

brahmaëo lokam adbhutam

SYNONYMS

sisākñäyäm—when there was the will to create; tataù—then; nābheù—
from the navel; tasya—of Him; padmam—a lotus; viniryayau—came out;
tat-nālam—its stem; hema-nalénam—like a golden lotus; brahmaëaù—of
Brahmā; lokam—the abode; adbhutam—wonderful.

TRANSLATION

When Viñëu lying in the ocean of milk wills to create this universe, a
golden lotus springs from His navel-pit. The golden lotus with its stem is the
abode of Brahmā representing Brahmāloka or Satyaloka.

PURPORT

“Gold” here means the dim reflection of pure cognition.

Bs 5.19

TEXT 19

TEXT

tattväni pürva-rüòhäni

käraëäni parasparam

samaväyāprayogāc ca

vibhinnāni pāthak pāthak

cit-çaktyā sajjamāno 'tha

bhagavān ādi-pūruṇaṁ

yojayan māyayā devo

yoga-nidrām akalpayat

SYNONYMS

tattvāni—elements; pūrva-rūḍhāni—previously created; kāraṇāni—causes; parasparam—mutually; samavāya—of the process of conglomeration; aprayogāt—from the nonapplication; ca—and; vibhinnāni—separate; pāthak pāthak—one from another; cit-çaktyā—with His spiritual potency; sajjamānaṁ—associating; atha—then; bhagavān—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; ādi-pūruṇaṁ—the primal Godhead; yojayan—causing to join; māyayā—with Māyā; devaṁ—the Lord; yoga-nidrām—Yoganidrā; akalpayat—He consorted with.

TRANSLATION

Before their conglomeration the primary elements in their nascent state remained originally separate entities. Nonapplication of the conglomerating process is the cause of their separate existence. Divine Mahā-Viñṇu, primal Godhead, through association with His own spiritual [cit] potency, moved Māyā and by the application of the conglomerating principle created those different entities in their state of cooperation. And after that He Himself consorted with Yoganidrā by way of His eternal dalliance with His spiritual [cit] potency.

PURPORT

Mayādhyakṣṇēa prakāṣṭiṁ sūyate sa-carācaram: [Bg. 9.10] “The mundane

energy prakāti gives birth to this universe of animate and inanimate beings by My direction.” The purport of this śloka of the Gétā is that Māyā, the perverted reflection of spiritual (cit) potency, was at first inactive and her extension of matter constituting the material cause was also in the separately dislocated state. In accordance with the will of Kāññēa this world is manifested as the resultant of the union of the efficient and the material causal principles of Māyā. In spite of that, the Supreme Lord Himself remains united with His cit potency. Yoganidrā. The word yoganidrā or yogamāyā indicates as follows: The nature of cit potency is manifestive of the Absolute Truth, while the nature of her perverted reflection, Māyā, is envelopment in the gloom of ignorance. When Kāññēa desires to manifest something in the mundane ignorance-wrapt affairs, He does this by the conjunction of His spiritual potency with His inactive nonspiritual potency. This is known as Yogamāyā. It carries a twofold notion, namely, transcendental notion and mundane inert notion. Kāññēa Himself, His subjective portions and those jēvas who are His unalloyed separated particles, realize the transcendental notion in that conjunction, while conditioned souls feel the mundane inert notion. The external coating of transcendental knowledge in the conscious activities of conditioned souls, bears the name of Yoganidrā. This is also an influence of the cit potency of the Divinity. This principle will be more elaborately considered hereafter.

Bs 5.20

TEXT 20

TEXT

vojayitvā tu tāny eva

praviveça svayaà guhām

guhāà praviññoe tasmiàs tu

jévātmā pratibudhyate

SYNONYMS

vojayitvā—after conglomerating; tu—then; täni—them; eva—certainly; praviveça—He entered; svayam—Himself; guhām—the hidden cavity; guhām—the hidden cavity; praviñõe—after He entered; tasmin—within that; tu—then; jéva-ātmā—the jévas; pratibudhyate—were awakened.

TRANSLATION

By conglomerating all those separate entities He manifested the innumerable mundane universes and Himself entered into the inmost recess of every extended conglomerate [viraò-vigraha]. At that time those jévas who had lain dormant during the cataclysm were awakened.

PURPORT

The word guhā (hidden cavity) bears various interpretations in the çāstras. In some portions the nonmanifestive pastimes of the Lord is called guhā and elsewhere the resting place of the indwelling spirit of all individual souls, is named guhā. In many places the inmost recesses of the heart of each individual is termed guhā. The main point is that the place which is hidden from the view of men in general, is designated guhā. Those jévas that were merged in Hari at the end of the life of Brahmā in the great cataclysm during the preceding great age of the universe, reappeared in this world in accordance with their former fruitive desires.

Bs 5.21

TEXT 21

TEXT

sa nityo nitya-sambandhaù

prakāṭiç ca paraiva sä

SYNONYMS

saù—that (jéva); nityaù—eternal; nitya-sambandhaù—possessing an

eternal relationship; prakāṭi—potency; ca—and; parā—spiritual; eva—certainly; sā—that.

TRANSLATION

The same jéva is eternal and is for eternity and without a beginning joined to the Supreme Lord by the tie of an eternal kinship. He is transcendental spiritual potency.

PURPORT

Just as the sun is eternally associated with his rays so the transcendental Supreme Lord is eternally joined with the jévas. The jévas are the infinitesimal particles of His spiritual effulgence and are, therefore, not perishable like mundane things. Jévas, being particles of Godhead's effulgent rays, exhibit on a minute scale the qualities of the Divinity. Hence jévas are identical with the principles of knowledge, knower, egoism, enjoyer, meditator and doer. Kāñēa is the all-pervading, all-extending Supreme Lord; while jévas have a different nature from His, being His atomic particles. That eternal relationship consists in this that the Supreme Lord is the eternal master and jévas are His eternal servants. Jévas have also sufficient eligibility in respect of the mellow quality of the Divinity. *Apareyam itas tv anyā prakāṭi viddhi me parām.* By this verse of the Gétā it is made known that jévas are His transcendental potency. All the qualities of the unalloyed soul are above the eightfold qualities such as egotism, etc., pertaining to His acit potency. Hence the jéva potency, though very small in magnitude, is still superior to acit potency or Māyā. This potency has another name, viz., taöasthä or marginal potency, being located on the line demarcating the spheres of the spiritual and mundane potencies. He is susceptible to the influence of the material energy owing to his small magnitude. But so long as he remains submissive to Kāñēa, the Lord of Māyā, he is not liable to the influence of Māyā. The worldly afflictions, births and rebirths are the concomitants of the fettered condition of souls fallen into the clutches of the deluding potency from a time that has no beginning.

Bs 5.22

TEXT 22

TEXT

evaà sarvātma-sambandhaà

nābhyāà padmaà harer abhüt

tatra brahmābhavad bhüyaç

catur-vedi catur-mukhaù

SYNONYMS

evam—thus; sarva-ātma—with all souls; sambandham—related; nābhyām—from the navel; padmam—a lotus; hareù—of Viñëu; abhüt—sprung up; tatra—there; brahmā—Brahmā; abhavat—was born; bhüyaù—again; catuù-vedé—versed in the four Vedas; catuù-mukhaù—four-faced.

TRANSLATION

The divine lotus which springs from the navel-pit of Viñëu is in every way related by the spiritual tie with all souls and is the origin of four-faced Brahmā versed in the four Vedas.

PURPORT

The same divine lotus originating from the divine person entered into the hidden recess, is the superior plane of aggregation of all individual souls. The four-faced Brahmā, the image of self-enjoyment, derives his origin from the prototype Brahmā or Hiraëyagarbha, the mundane seminal principle, who regards the aggregate of all mundane entities as his own proper body. The delegated godship of Brahmā as well as his being the dislocated portion of Kåñëa, are also established.

Bs 5.23

TEXT 23

TEXT

saījāto bhagavac-chaktyā

tat-kālaà kila coditaù

sisākñāyāà matià cakre

pūrva-saàskāra-saàskātaù

dadarça kevalaà dhvāntaà

nānyat kim api sarvataù

SYNONYMS

saījātaù—on being born; bhagavat-çaktyā—by the divine potency; tat-kālam—at that time; kila—indeed; coditaù—being guided; sisākñāyām—to the act of creation; matim—his mind; cakre—turned; pūrva-saàskāra-saàskātaù—under the impulse of previous impressions; dadarça—he saw; kevalam—only; dhvāntam—darkness; na—not; anyat—else; kim api—anything; sarvataù—in every direction.

TRANSLATION

On coming out of the lotus, Brahmā, being guided by the divine potency tuned his mind to the act of creation under the impulse of previous impressions. But he could see nothing but darkness in every direction.

PURPORT

Brahmā's impulse for creation arises solely from his previous impressions. All jēvas get their nature conformably to their impressions of previous births and accordingly their activity can have a beginning. It is called “the unseen” or the result of one's previous deeds. His natural

impulse is formed according to the nature of the deeds done by him in the previous kalpa. Some of the eligible jévas also attain to the office of Brahmä in this way.

Bs 5.24

TEXT 24

TEXT

uvāca puratas tasmai

tasya divya sarasvaté

kāma-kāññäya govinda

he gopé-jana ity api

vallabhāya priyā vahner

mantram te dāsyati priyam

SYNONYMS

uvāca—said; purataù—in front; tasmai—to him; tasya—of Him (the Supreme Lord); divyā—divine; sarasvaté—the goddess of learning; kāma—the kāma-béja (kléà); kāññäya—to Kāññä; govinda—govindäya, to Govinda; he—O; gopé-jana—of the gopés; iti—thus; api—also; vallabhāya—to the dear one; priyā vahneù—the wife of Agni, Svähä (the word svähä is uttered while offering oblations); mantram—mantra; te—to you; dāsyati—will give; priyam—the heart’s desire.

TRANSLATION

Then the goddess of learning Sarasvaté, the divine consort of the Supreme Lord, said thus to Brahmä who saw nothing but gloom in all directions, “O Brahmä, this mantra, viz., kléà kāññäya govindäya gopé-jana-

vallabhäya svähä, will assuredly fulfill your heart's desire.”

PURPORT

The mantra, consisting of the eighteen divine letters prefixed by the kâma-béja, is alone superexcellent. It has a twofold aspect. One aspect is that it tends to make the pure soul run after all-attractive Çré Kåñëa, the Lord of Gokula and the divine milkmaids. This is the acme of the spiritual tendency of jévas. When the devotee is free from all sorts of mundane desires and willing to serve the Lord he attains the fruition of his heart's desire, viz., the love of Kåñëa. But in the case of the devotee who is not of unmixed aptitude this superexcellent mantra fulfills his heart's desire also. The transcendental kâma-béja is inherent in the divine logos located in Goloka; and the kâma-béja pervertedly reflected in the worldly affairs satisfies all sorts of desires of this mundane world.

Bs 5.25

TEXT 25

TEXT

tapas tvaà tapa etena

tava siddhir bhaviñyati

SYNONYMS

tapaù—spiritual austerity; tvam—you; tapa—practice; etena—by this; tava—your; siddhiù—fulfillment; bhaviñyati—will be.

TRANSLATION

“O Brahmä, do thou practice spiritual association by means of this mantra; then all your desires will be fulfilled.”

PURPORT

Its purport is clear.

Bs 5.26

TEXT 26

TEXT

atha tepe sa suciraà

préëan govindam avyayam

çvetadvépa-patià kãñëaà

goloka-sthaà parät param

prakåtyä guëa-rüpiëyâ

rüpiëyâ paryupäsitam

sahasra-dala-sampanne

koöi-kījalka-båàhite

bhümiç cintämaëis tatra

karëikäre mahäsane

samäsénaà cid-änandaà

jyoti-rüpaà sanātanam

çabda-brahma-mayaà veëuà

vādayantaà mukhāmbuje

vilāsiné-gaëa-vātaà

svaiù svair aàçair abhiñöutam

SYNONYMS

atha—then; tepe—practiced austerity; saù—he (Brahmä); suciram—for a long time; préëan—satisfying; govindam—Govinda; avyayam—imperishable; çvetadvépa-patim—the Lord of Çvetadvépa; kãñëam—Kãñëa; goloka-stham—situated in Goloka; parät param—the greatest of all; prakåtyä—by the external energy; guëa-rüpiëyâ—embodying all mundane qualities; rüpiëyâ—possessing form; paryupäsitam—worshiped from outside; sahasra-dala-sampanne—on a lotus of a thousand petals; koöi-kïjjalka—by millions of filaments; bâähite—augmented; bhümiù—the land; cintämaëiù—magical touchstone; tatra—there; karëikäre—on the whorl; mahä-äsane—on a great throne; samäsënam—seated; cit-änandam—the form of transcendental bliss; jyotiù-rüpam—the form of effulgence; sanätanam—eternal; çabda-brahma—divine sound; mayam—comprising; veëum—the flute; vädayantam—playing; mukha-ambuje—at His lotus mouth; vilāsiné-gaëa—by the gopés; vâtam—surrounded; svaiù svaiù—own respective; aàçaiù—by subjective portions; abhiñöutam—worshiped.

TRANSLATION

Brahmä, being desirous of satisfying Govinda, practiced the cultural acts for Kãñëa in Goloka, Lord of Çvetadvépa, for a long time. His meditation ran thus, “There exists a divine lotus of a thousand petals, augmented by millions of filaments, in the transcendental land of Goloka. On its whorl, there exists a great divine throne on which is seated Çré Kãñëa, the form of eternal effulgence of transcendental bliss, playing on His divine flute resonant with the divine sound, with His lotus mouth. He is worshiped by His amorous milkmaids with their respective subjective portions and extensions and also by His external energy [who stays outside] embodying all mundane qualities.”

PURPORT

Although the object of meditation is fully transcendental, yet owing to her nature which is permeated with the quality of active mundane hankering, Mâyä, the nonspiritual potency of Kåñëa, embodying the principles of mixed sattva, rajas, and tamas, in the forms of Durgä, and other nonspiritual powers, meditated on the Supreme Lord Kåñëa as the object of their worship. So long as there is any trace of mundane desire in one's heart, it is the object of worship of Mâyädevé (Durgä) who has to be worshiped by such a person; nevertheless the fulfillment of one's heart's desire results from the worship of the object of worship of Mâyädevé, and not from the worship of Mâyädevé herself. This is in accordance with the çloka, akämaù sarva-kämo vä mokña-käma udära-dhiù/ tévreëa bhakti-yogena yajeta puruññaà param [SB 2.3.10]. The meaning of this çloka of the Bhägavatam is that though other gods, as distinct manifestations of the Supreme Lord, are bestowers of sundry specific boons, yet a sensible person should worship the all powerful Supreme Lord, giver of all good, with unalloyed devotion, without worshiping those mundane gift-giving deities. Accordingly. Brahmä meditated upon Kåñëa in Goloka, the object of the worship, from a distance, of Mâyädevé. True devotion is unalloyed devotional activity free from all mundane desire. The devotion of Brahmä, etc., is not unmixed devotion. But there is a stage of unmixed predilection even in devotion for the attainment of one's selfish desire. This has been fully described in the concluding five çlokas of this work. That is the easiest method of divine service, prior to the attainment of self-realization, by fallen souls.

Bs 5.27

TEXT 27

TEXT

atha veëu-ninädasya

trayé-mürti-mayé gatiù

sphuranté praviveçäçu

mukhābjāni svayambhuvaṇ

gāyatrēḥ gāyatas tasmād

adhigatya sarojajaṇ

saṅskṛtāḥ cādi-guruḥ

dvijatām agamat tataḥ

SYNONYMS

atha—then; veṇu-ninādasya—of the sound of the flute; trayé-mūrti-mayé—the mother of the three Vedas; gatiḥ—the means (the Gāyatrī mantra); sphuranti—being made manifest; praviveṣa—entered; āḥu—quickly; mukha-abjāni—the lotus faces; svayambhuvaṇ—of Brahmā; gāyatrīm—the Gāyatrī; gāyataḥ—sounding; tasmāt—from Him (Ṛṣi Kāṇḍa); adhigatya—having received; saroja-jaṇ—the lotus-born (Brahmā); saṅskṛtāḥ—initiated; ca—and; ādi-guruḥ—by the primal preceptor; dvijatām—the status of the twice-born; agamat—attained; tataḥ—thereafter.

TRANSLATION

Then Gāyatrī, mother of the Vedas, being made manifest, i.e. imparted, by the divine sound of the flute of Ṛṣi Kāṇḍa, entered into the lotus mouth of Brahmā, born from himself, through his eight ear-holes. The lotus-born Brahmā having received the Gāyatrī, sprung from the flute-song of Ṛṣi Kāṇḍa, attained the status of the twice-born, having been initiated by the supreme primal preceptor, Godhead Himself.

PURPORT

The sound of Kāṇḍa's flute is the transcendental blissful sound; hence the archetype of all Veda, is present in it. The Gāyatrī is Vedic rhythm. It contains a brief meditation and prayer. Kāma-gāyatrī is the highest of all the Gāyatrīs, because the meditation and prayer contained in it are full of

the perfect transcendental sportive activities which are not to be found in any other Gäyatré. The Gäyatré that is attained as the sequel of the eighteen-lettered mantra is käma-gäyatré which runs thus: kléà käma-deväya vidmahe puñpa-bäëäya dhémahi tan no 'naìgaù pracodayät. In this Gäyatré, the realization of the transcendental pastimes of Çré Gopéjana-vallabha after perfect meditation and the prayer for the attainment of the transcendental god of love are indicated. In the spiritual world there is no better mode of endeavor for securing the superexcellent rasa-bedewed love. As soon as that Gäyatré entered into the ear-holes of Brahmä, he became the twice-born and began to chant the Gäyatré. Whoever has received the same Gäyatré in reality. has attained his spiritual rebirth. The status of a twice-born that is obtained in accordance with one's worldly nature and lineage, by the fettered souls in this mundane world, is far inferior to that of the twice-born who obtains admission into the transcendental world; because the initiation or acquisition of transcendental birth as a result of spiritual initiation is the highest of glories in as much as the jéva is thereby enabled to attain to the transcendental realm.

Bs 5.28

TEXT 28

TEXT

trayyā prabuddho 'tha vidhir

véjīāta-tattva-sāgaraù

tuñöäva veda-säreëa

stotreëänena keçavam

SYNONYMS

trayyā—by the embodiment of the three Vedas; prabuddhaù—enlightened; atha—then; vidhiù—Brahmä; vijīāta—acquainted with; tattva-

sāgaraù—the ocean of truth; tuñöäva—worshipped; veda-säreëa—which is the essence of all Vedas; stotreëa—by the hymn; anena—this; keçavam—Çré Kåñëa.

TRANSLATION

Enlightened by the recollection of that Gäyatrë, embodying the three Vedas, Brahmä became acquainted with the expanse of the ocean of truth. Then he worshiped Çré Kåñëa, the essence of all Vedas, with this hymn.

PURPORT

Brahmä thought thus within himself, “By the recollection of käma-gäyatrë it seems to me that I am the eternal maidservant of Kåñëa.” Though the other mysteries in regard to the condition of the maidservant of Kåñëa were not revealed to him, Brahmä, by dint of his searching self-consciousness, became well acquainted with the ocean of truth. All the truths of the Vedas were revealed to him and with the help of those essences of the Vedas he offered this hymn to the Supreme Lord Çré Kåñëa. Çrémän Mahäprabhu has taught this hymn to His favorite disciples in as much as it fully contains all the transcendental truths regarding the Vaiñëava philosophy. Readers are requested to study and try to enter into the spirit of his hymn with great care and attention, as a regular daily function.

Bs 5.29

TEXT 29

TEXT

cintämaëi-prakara-sadmasu kalpa-våkña-

lakñävâteñu surabhir abhipälayantam

lakñmé-sahasra-çata-sambhrama-sevyamänaà

govindam ädi-puruṇaà tam ahaà bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

cintāmaëi—touchstone; prakara—groups made of; sadmasu—in abodes; kalpa-vākṇa—of desire trees; lakṇa—by millions; ävâteṇu—surrounded; surabhiu—surabhi cows; abhipālayantam—tending; lakṇmé—of goddesses of fortune; sahasra—of thousands; çata—by hundreds; sambhrama—with great respect; sevyaṁānam—being served; govindam—Govinda; ädi-puruṇam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajāmi—worship.

TRANSLATION

I worship Govinda, the primeval Lord, the first progenitor who is tending the cows, yielding all desire, in abodes built with spiritual gems, surrounded by millions of purpose trees, always served with great reverence and affection by hundreds of thousands of lakṇmés or gopés.

PURPORT

By the word cintāmaëi is meant “transcendental gem.” Just as Mäyā builds this mundane universe with the five material elements, so the spiritual (cit) potency has built the spiritual world of transcendental gems. The cintāmaëi which serves as material in the building of the abode of the Supreme Lord of Goloka, is a far rarer and more agreeable entity than the philosopher’s stone. The purpose tree yields only the fruits of piety, wealth, fulfillment of desire and liberation; but the purpose trees in the abode of Kāṇṇa bestow innumerable fruits in the shape of checkered divine love. Kāma-dhenus (cows yielding the fulfillment of desire) give milk when they are milked; but the kāma-dhenus of Goloka pour forth oceans of milk in the shape of the fountain of love showering transcendental bliss that does away with the hunger and thirst of all pure devotees. The words lakṇa and sahasra-çata signify endless numbers. The word sambhrama or sādara indicates “being saturated with love.” Here lakṇmé denotes gopé. Ädi-puruṇa means, “He who is the primeval Lord.”

Bs 5.30

TEXT 30

TEXT

veëuà kvaëantam aravinda-daläyatäkñam-

barhävataàsam asitāmbuda-sundarāigam

kandarpa-koöi-kamanéya-viçeña-çobhaà

govindam ädi-puruñaà tam ahaà bhajämi

SYNONYMS

veëum—the flute; kvaëantam—playing; aravinda-dala—(like) lotus petals; äyata—blooming; akñam—whose eyes; barha—a peacock’s feather; avataàsam—whose ornament on the head; asita-ambuda—(tinged with the hue of) blue clouds; sundara—beautiful; aigam—whose figure; kandarpa—of Cupids; koöi—millions; kamanéya—charming; viçeña—unique; çobham—whose loveliness; govindam—Govinda; ädi-puruñam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajämi—worship.

TRANSLATION

I worship Govinda, the primeval Lord, who is adept in playing on His flute, with blooming eyes like lotus petals with head decked with peacock’s feather, with the figure of beauty tinged with the hue of blue clouds, and His unique loveliness charming millions of Cupids.

PURPORT

The matchless beauty of Kåñëa, the Supreme Lord of Goloka, is being described. Kåñëa, the all-pervading cognition, has a spiritual form of His own. The form of Kåñëa is not a fanciful creation of imagination formed after visualizing the beautiful things of the world. What Brahmä saw in his

ecstatic trance of pure devotion, is being described. Kåñëa is engaged in playing upon His flute. That flute by his enchanting musical sound attracts the hearts of all living beings. Just as a lotus petal produces a pleasant sight, so the two beautiful eyes of Kåñëa who causes the manifestation of our spiritual vision, display the unlimited splendor and beauty of His moonlike face. The loveliness that adorns His head with peacock feather figures, the corresponding feature of the spiritual beauty of Kåñëa. Just as a mass of blue clouds offers a specifically soothing, pleasant view, the complexion of Kåñëa is analogously tinged with a spiritual dark-blue color. The beauty and loveliness of Kåñëa is far more enchanting than that of Cupid multiplied a millionfold.

Bs 5.31

TEXT 31

TEXT

älola-candraka-lasad-vanamälya-vaàçé-

ratnäigadaà praëaya-keli-kalä-viläsam

çyāmaà tri-bhaiga-lalitaà niyata-prakāçaà

govindam ädi-puruñaà tam ahaà bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

älola—swinging; candraka—with a moon-locket; lasat—beautified; vana-mälya—a garland of flowers; vaàçé—flute; ratna-aigadam—adorned with jeweled ornaments; praëaya—of love; keli-kalä—in pastimes; viläsam—who always revels; çyāmam—Çyāmasundara; tri-bhaiga—bending in three places; lalitam—graceful; niyata—eternally; prakāçam—manifest; govindam—Govinda; ädi-puruñam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajāmi—worship.

TRANSLATION

I worship Govinda, the primeval Lord, round whose neck is swinging a garland of flowers beautified with the moon-locket, whose two hands are adorned with the flute and jeweled ornaments, who always revels in pastimes of love, whose graceful threefold-bending form of Çyāmasundara is eternally manifest.

PURPORT

In the ṣloka beginning with cintāmaëi-prakara the transcendental region and the spiritual names of Govinda, in the ṣloka beginning with veëuà kvaëantam, the eternal beautiful form of Govinda and in this ṣloka the amorous pastimes of Govinda, the embodiment of His sixty-four excellences, have been described. All the spiritual affairs that come within the scope of description in the narration of the ecstatic mellow quality (rasa) are included in the spiritual amorous sports of Govinda.

Bs 5.32

TEXT 32

TEXT

aigäni yasya sakalendriya-våtti-manti

paçyanti pänti kalayanti ciraà jaganti

änanda-cinmaya-sad-ujjvala-vigrahasya

govindam ädi-puruñaà tam ahaà bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

aigäni—the limbs; yasya—of whom; sakala-indriya—of all the organs; våtti-manti—possessing the functions; paçyanti—see; pänti—maintain; kalayanti—manifest; cira—eternally;; jaganti—the universes; änanda—bliss; cit—truth; maya—full of; sat—substantiality; ujjvala—full of dazzling splendor; vigrahasya—whose form; govindam—Govinda; ädi-puruñam—

the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajāmi—worship.

TRANSLATION

I worship Govinda, the primeval Lord, whose transcendental form is full of bliss, truth, substantiality and is thus full of the most dazzling splendor. Each of the limbs of that transcendental figure possesses in Himself, the full-fledged functions of all the organs, and eternally sees, maintains and manifests the infinite universes, both spiritual and mundane.

PURPORT

For want of a taste of things spiritual, a grave doubt arises in the minds of those who are enchained by worldly knowledge. On hearing a narration of the pastimes of Kāñḍea they think that the truth (tattva) regarding Kāñḍea is the mental concoction of certain learned scholars, created by their imaginative brains out of material drawn from the mundane principles. With the object of removing this harmful doubt, Brahmā in this and the three following ślokaś, after distinguishing between the two things, viz., spirit and matter, in a rational manner, has tried to make one understand the pure lēlā of Kāñḍea, obtained by his unmixed ecstatic trance. Brahmā wants to say that the form of Kāñḍea is all “existence, all-knowledge and all-bliss, whereas all mundane experiences are full of palpable ignorance. Although there is specific difference between the two, the fundamental truth is that spiritual affairs constitute the absolute source. Specification and variegatedness are ever present in it. By them are established the transcendental abode, form, name, quality and sports of Kāñḍea. It is only by a person, possessed of pure spiritual knowledge and freedom from any relationship with Māyā, that those amorous pastimes of Kāñḍea can at all be appreciated. The spiritual abode, the seat of pastimes, emanated from the cit potency and formed of cintāmaṇi (transcendental philosopher’s stone), and the figure of Kāñḍea, are all spiritual. Just as Māyā is the perverted reflection of the spiritual potency. the variegatedness created by Māyā (ignorance) is also a perverted reflection of spiritual variegatedness. So a mere semblance of the spiritual variegatedness is only noticed in this mundane world. Notwithstanding such semblance the two are wholly different from one another. The unwholesomeness of matter is its defect;

but in the spirit there is variegatedness which is free from any fault or contamination. The soul and the body of Kåñëa are identical, whereas the body and soul of fallen creatures are not so. In the spiritual sphere there is no such difference as that between the body and soul, between the limbs and their proprietor, between the attributes and the object possessing them, of this world. But such difference really exists in the case of conditioned souls. Limbed though Kåñëa is, His every limb is the whole entity. He performs all varieties of divine spiritual functions with every one of His limbs. Hence He is an indivisible whole and a perfect transcendental entity. Both jéva-soul and Kåñëa are transcendental. So they belong to the same category. But they differ in this that the transcendental attributes exist in the jéva-soul in infinitesimally small degrees, whereas in Kåñëa they are found in their fullest perfection. Those attributes manifest themselves in their proper infinitesimality only when the jéva-soul attains his unadulterated spiritual status. The jéva-soul attains the nearest approach to the absolute identity only when the spiritual force of ecstatic energy appears in him by the grace of Kåñëa. Still Kåñëa remains the object of universal homage by reason of His possession of certain unique attributes. These fourfold unrivaled attributes do not manifest themselves in Nārāyaëa, the Lord of Vaikuëöha or in primeval puruñä-avatāras, or in the highest deities such as Çiva, not to speak of jévas.

Bs 5.33

TEXT 33

TEXT

advaitam acyutam anādim ananta-rūpam

ädyaà puräëa-puruñäà nava-yauvanaà ca

vedeñu durlabham adurlabham ätma-bhaktau

govindam ädi-puruñäà tam ahaà bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

advaitam—without a second; acyutam—without decay; anādim—without a beginning; ananta-rūpam—whose form is endless, or who possesses unlimited forms; ādyam—the beginning; purāṇa-puruṇam—the most ancient person; nava-yauvanam—a blooming youth; ca—also; vedeṇu—through the Vedas; durlabham—inaccessible; adurlabham—not difficult to obtain; ātma-bhaktau—through pure devotion of the soul; govindam—Govinda; ādi-puruṇam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajāmi—worship.

TRANSLATION

I worship Govinda, the primeval Lord, who is inaccessible to the Vedas, but obtainable by pure unalloyed devotion of the soul, who is without a second, who is not subject to decay, is without a beginning, whose form is endless, who is the beginning, and the eternal puruṇa; yet He is a person possessing the beauty of blooming youth.

PURPORT

Advaita means “indivisible truth who is knowledge absolute.” Brahman, the infinite, emanates from Him as His effulgence and God-immanent (Paramātmā) as His constituent; but nevertheless He remains one and indivisible. Acyuta means that though myriads of avatāras emanate from Him as subjective portions and millions of jēvas as separated spiritual particles, still He remains intact as the undivided whole of fullest perfection. Though He indulges in exhibiting the pastimes of births, etc., still He is without a beginning. Though He disappears after the pastimes of His appearance, still He is eternal. Though without origin, yet He is with an origin in His pastime of appearance; and although eternal in essence, He is still a person in the full bloom of youth. The sum and substance of it is that though He possesses diverse and apparently mutually contradictory qualities, still they are in universal harmonious concordance by dint of His unthinkable potency. This is what is meant by cid-dharma (transcendental nature) as distinguished from the material. His graceful threefold-bending form with flute in hand, possesses eternal blooming youth and is above all unwholesomeness that is to be found in limited time and space. In the transcendental realm there is no past and future but only the unalloyed

and immutable present time. In the transcendental sphere there is no distinction between the object and its qualities and no such identity as is found in the limited mundane region. Hence those qualities that seem to be apparently contradictory in the light of mundane conception limited by time and space, exist in agreeable and dainty concordance in the spiritual realm. How can the jéva realize such unprecedented existence? The limited intellectual function of the jéva is always contaminated by the influence of time and space and is, therefore, not in a position to shake off this limitedness. If the potency of cognitive function does not extend to the realization of the transcendental, what else can? In reply. Brahmä says that the transcendental Absolute is beyond the reach of the Vedas. The Vedas originate in sound and sound originates in the mundane ether. So the Vedas cannot present before us a direct view of the transcendental world (Goloka). It is only when the Vedas are imbued with the cit potency that they are enabled to deal with the transcendental. But Goloka reveals itself to every jéva-soul when he is under the influence of the spiritual cognitive potency joined to the essence of ecstatic energy. The ecstatic function of devotion is boundless and is surcharged with unalloyed transcendental knowledge. That knowledge reveals goloka-tattva (the principle of the highest transcendental) in unison with devotion, without asserting itself separately but as a subsidiary to unalloyed devotion.

Bs 5.34

TEXT 34

TEXT

panthäs tu koöi-çata-vatsara-sampragamyö

väyör athäpi manaso muni-puigavänäm

so 'py asti yat-prapada-sémny avicintya-tattve

govindam ädi-puruñaà tam ahaà bhajämi

SYNONYMS

panthäù—the path; tu—but; koöi-çata—thousands of millions; vatsara—of years; sampragamyäù—extending over; väyoù—of wind; atha api—or; manasaù—of the mind; muni-puigavänäm—of the foremost jñānēs; saù—that (path); api—only; asti—is; yat—of whom; prapada—of the toe; sémni—to the tip; avicintya-tattve—beyond material conception; govindam—Govinda; ädi-puruñam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajāmi—worship.

TRANSLATION

I worship Govinda, the primeval Lord, only the tip of the toe of whose lotus feet is approached by the yogēs who aspire after the transcendental and betake themselves to prāëyāma by drilling the respiration; or by the jñānēs who try to find out the nondifferentiated Brahman by the process of elimination of the mundane, extending over thousands of millions of years.

PURPORT

The attainment of the lotus feet of Govinda consists in the realization of unalloyed devotion. The kaivalya (realized nonalternative state) which is attained by the añöäiga-yogis by practicing trance for thousands of millions of years and the state of merging into the nondifferentiated impersonality of Godhead beyond the range of limitation attained by nondualists after a similar period passed in distinguishing between the spiritual and nonspiritual and eliminating things of the limited sphere one after another by the formula “not this, not that,” are simply the outskirts of the lotus feet of Kāñëa and not the lotus feet themselves. The long and short of the matter is this, kaivalya or merging into the Brahman constitutes the line of demarcation between the world of limitation and the transcendental world. For, unless we step beyond them, we can have no taste of the variegatedness of the transcendental sphere. These conditions are the simple absence of misery arising from mundane affinity but are not real happiness or felicity. If the absence of misery be called a bit of pleasure then also that bit is very small and of no consequence. It is not sufficient to destroy the condition of materiality; but the real gain to the jéva is his eternal existence in his self-realized state. This can be attained only by the grace of unalloyed devotion which is essentially cit or transcendental in

character. For this end abstract and uninteresting mental speculation is of no avail.

Bs 5.35

TEXT 35

TEXT

eko 'py asau racayituà jagad-aëòa-koöià

yac-chaktir asti jagad-aëòa-cayä yad-antaù

aëòäntara-stha-paramäëu-cayäntara-stham-

govindam ädi-puruñaà tam ahaà bhajämi

SYNONYMS

ekaù—one; api—although; asau—He; racayitum—to create; jagat-aëòa—of universes; koöim—millions; yat—whose; çaktiù—potency; asti—there is; jagat-aëòa-cayäù—all the universes; yat-antaù—within whom; aëòa-antara-stha—which are scattered throughout the universe; parama-aëu-caya—the atoms; antara-stham—situated within; govindam—Govinda; ädi-puruñam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajämi—worship.

TRANSLATION

He is an undifferentiated entity as there is no distinction between potency and the possessor thereof. In His work of creation of millions of worlds, His potency remains inseparable. All the universes exist in Him and He is present in His fullness in every one of the atoms that are scattered throughout the universe, at one and the same time. Such is the primeval Lord whom I adore.

PURPORT

Kåñëa is the highest of all entities. In Him is an entity which is termed cit (spiritual) which is distinct from the principle of limitation. By His inconceivable power, He can at will create numberless universes. All the mundane universes owe their origin to the transformation of His external potency. Again His abode is beyond human conception; since all worlds, limited and spiritual (cit) exist in Him and He resides simultaneously in His fullness and entirety in all the atoms in all the worlds. All-pervasiveness is only a localized aspect of the majesty of Kåñëa, the Lord of all. Though He is all-pervasive yet in His existence everywhere in a medium shape consists His spiritual Lordship beyond human conception. This argument favors the doctrine of simultaneous inconceivable distinction and nondistinction, and knocks down the contaminating Mâyävâda and other allied doctrines.

Bs 5.36

TEXT 36

TEXT

yad-bhâva-bhâvita-dhiyo manujäs tathaiva

samprâpya rūpa-mahimäsana-yâna-bhüñäù

süktair yam eva nigama-prathitaiù stuvanti

govindam ädi-puruñaà tam ahaà bhajämi

SYNONYMS

yat—for whom; bhâva—with devotion; bhâvita—are imbued; dhiyaù—whose hearts; manujäù—men; tathä eva—similarly; samprâpya—having gained; rūpa—beauty; mahima—greatness; äsana—thrones; yâna—conveyances; bhüñäù—and ornaments; süktaiù—by Vedic hymns; yam—whom; eva—certainly; nigama—by the Vedas; prathitaiù—told; stuvanti—offer praise; govindam—Govinda; ädi-puruñam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajämi—worship.

TRANSLATION

I adore the same Govinda, the primeval Lord, in whose praise men, who are imbued with devotion, sing the mantra-sūktas told by the Vedas, by gaining their appropriate beauty, greatness, thrones, conveyances and ornaments.

PURPORT

In discussing rasa we meet with five kinds of devotion or service. Čānta or unattached, dāsya or pertaining to reverential willing service, sakhya or friendship, vātsalya or parental love and čālgāra or juvenile love.

The devotees surcharged with the ideas of their respective service, serve Kāñēa eternally and ultimately reach the goal of their respective ideals. They attain the real nature of their self befitting their respective rasas, their glories, conveyances, seats befitting their sacred service, and transcendental qualities of ornaments enhancing the beauty of their real nature. Those who are advocates of čānta-rasa attain the region of Brahma-Paramātmā, the seat of eternal peace; those of dāsya-rasa get to Vaikuēōha, the spiritual majestic abode of Čré Nārāyaēa; those of sakhya, vātsalya and madhura-rasa (juvenile love) attain Goloka-dhāma, Kāñēa's abode, above Vaikuēōha. They worship Kāñēa by the sūktas depicted in the Vedas with the ingredients and objects befitting their respective rasas, in those regions. The Vedas, under the influence of the spiritual potency in certain passages speak of the pastimes of the Supreme Lord. The liberated souls chant the name, qualities and pastimes of the Supreme Lord, under the guidance of the same spiritual potency.

Bs 5.37

TEXT 37

TEXT

ānanda-cinmaya-rasa-pratibhāvitābhis

tābhir ya eva nija-rūpatayā kalābhiù

goloka eva nivasaty akhilātma-bhūto

govindam ādi-puruṇā tam aha bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

ānanda—bliss; cit—and knowledge; maya—consisting of; rasa—mellows; prati—every second; bhāvitābhiù—who are engrossed with; tābhiù—with those; yaù—who; eva—certainly; nija-rūpatayā—with His own form; kalābhiù—who are parts of portions of His pleasure potency; goloke—in Goloka Vāndāvana; eva—certainly; nivasati—resides; akhila-ātma—as the soul of all; bhūtaù—who exists; govindam—Govinda; ādi-puruṇam—the original personality; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajāmi—worship.

TRANSLATION

I worship Govinda, the primeval Lord, residing in His own realm, Goloka, with Rādhā, resembling His own spiritual figure, the embodiment of the ecstatic potency possessed of the sixty-four artistic activities, in the company of Her confidantes [sakhés], embodiments of the extensions of Her bodily form, permeated and vitalized by His ever-blissful spiritual rasa.

PURPORT

Although the Lord Absolute and His potency are one and the self-same existence, still They exist eternally as separate entities, as Rādhā and Kāñēa. In both the ecstatic energy and the transcendental Lord Kāñēa, there exists çāigāra-rasa (amorous love) whose quality is inconceivable. The vibhāva (extension) of that rasa (mellow quality) is twofold, viz., ālambana (prop) and uddēpana (stimulation). Of these ālambana is twofold, viz., āçraya (supported) and viñaya (supporter). Āçraya signifies Rādhikā Herself and the extensions of Her own form and viñaya means Kāñēa Himself. Kāñēa is Govinda, Lord of Goloka. The gopés are the facsimile āçraya of that rasa. With them Kāñēa indulges in eternal pastimes in Goloka. Nija-rūpatayā means “with the attributes manifested from the ecstatic energy.” The sixty-

four activities in fine arts and crafts are the following: (1) géta—art of singing. (2) vädya—art of playing on musical instruments. (3) nātya—art of dancing. (4) nāöya—art of theatricals. (5) älekhyā—art of painting. (6) viçeñakacchedya—art of painting the face and body with colored unguents and cosmetics. (7) taëòula-kusuma-balé-vikära—art of preparing offerings from rice and flowers. (8) puñpāstaraëa—art of making a covering of flowers for a bed. (9) daçana-vasanāiga-rāga—art of applying preparations for cleansing the teeth, cloths and painting the body. (10) maëi-bhümikā-karma—art of making the groundwork of jewels. (11) çayyā-racana—art of covering the bed. (12) udaka-vädya—art of playing on music in water. (13) udaka-ghāta—art of splashing with water. (14) citra-yoga—art of practically applying an admixture of colors. (15) mälly-grathana-vikalpa—art of designing a preparation of wreaths. (16) çekharäpéòa-yojana—art of practically setting the coronet on the head. (17) nepathya-yoga—art of practically dressing in the tiring room. (18) karëapātra-bhaiga—art of decorating the tragus of the ear. (19) sugandha-yukti—art of practical application of aromatics. (20) bhüñäëa-yojana—art of applying or setting ornaments. (21) aindra-jāla—art of jugglery. (22) kaucumära—a kind of art. (23) hasta-lāghava—art of sleight of hand. (24) citra-çäkāpüpa-bhakñya-vikära-kriyā—art of preparing varieties of salad, bread, cake and delicious food. (25) pānaka-rasa-rägāsava-yojana—art of practically preparing palatable drinks and tinging draughts with red color. (26) sücé-vāya-karma—art of needleworks and weaving. (27) sütra-kréòa—art of playing with thread. (28) véëä-òamuraka-vädya—art of playing on lute and small x-shaped drum. (29) prahelikā—art of making and solving riddles. (29-a) pratimälä—art of caping or reciting verse for verse as a trial for memory or skill. (30) durvacaka-yoga—art of practicing language difficult to be answered by others. (31) pustaka-vācana—art of reciting books. (32) nāöikākhyäyikā-darçana—art of enacting short plays and anecdotes. (33) kāvya-samasyā-püraëa—art of solving enigmatic verses. (34) paööikā-vetra-bäëa-vikalpa—art of designing preparation of shield, cane and arrows. (35) tarku-karma—art of spinning by spindle. (36) takñäëa—art of carpentry. (37) västu-vidyā—art of engineering. (38) raupya-ratna-parékñä—art of testing silver and jewels. (39) dhātu-vāda—art of metallurgy. (40) maëi-rāga-jāna—art of tinging jewels. (41) äkara-jāna—art of mineralogy. (42) vākñäyur-veda-yoga—art of practicing medicine or medical treatment, by herbs. (43) meñä-kukkuöa-lāvaka-yuddha-vidhi—art of knowing the mode

of fighting of lambs, cocks and birds. (44) çuka-çärikä-prapālana (pralāpana)?—art of maintaining or knowing conversation between male and female cockatoos. (45) utsādana—art of healing or cleaning a person with perfumes. (46) keça-mārjana-kauçala—art of combing hair. (47) akñara-muñöikä-kathana—art of talking with letters and fingers. (48) mlecchita-kutarka-vikalpa—art of fabricating barbarous or foreign sophistry. (49) deça-bhāñä-jñāna—art of knowing provincial dialects. (50) puñpa-çakaöikä-nirmiti-jñāna—art of knowing prediction by heavenly voice or knowing preparation of toy carts by flowers. (51) yantra-mätākä—art of mechanics. (52) dhāraëa-mätākä—art of the use of amulets. (53) samväcya—art of conversation. (54) mānasé kävya-kriyā—art of composing verse mentally. (55) kriyā-vikalpa—art of designing a literary work or a medical remedy. (56) chalitaka-yoga—art of practicing as a builder of shrines called after him. (57) abhidhāna-koña-cchando-jñāna—art of the use of lexicography and meters. (58) vastra-gopana—art of concealment of cloths. (59) dyüta-viçeña—art of knowing specific gambling. (60) äkarña-kréöä—art of playing with dice or magnet. (61) bälaka-kréöanaka—art of using children’s toys. (62) vainäyiké vidyā—art of enforcing discipline. (63) vaijayiké vidyā—art of gaining victory. (64) vaitäliké vidyā—art of awakening master with music at dawn.

All these arts manifesting their own eternal forms are ever visible in the region of Goloka as the ingredients of rasa; and, in the mundane sphere, they have been unstintedly exhibited in the pastimes of Vraja by the spiritual (cit) potency. Yogamäyā. So Çré Rüpa says, sadānantaiù... santi täù, i.e., Kāñëa is ever manifest in His beauty with His infinite pastimes in Goloka. Sometimes the variant manifestation of those pastimes becomes visible on the mundane plane. Çré Hari, the Supreme Lord, also manifests His pastimes of birth, etc., accompanied by all His paraphernalia. The divine sportive potency fills the hearts of His paraphernalia with appropriate spiritual sentiments in conformity with the will of Kāñëa. Those pastimes that manifest themselves on the mundane plane, are His visible pastimes. All those very pastimes exist in their nonvisible form in Goloka beyond the ken of mundane knowledge. In His visible pastimes Kāñëa sojourns in Gokula, Mathurā and Dvārakā. Those pastimes that are nonvisible in those three places, are visible in their spiritual sites of Vändāvana.

From the conclusions just stated it is clear that there is no distinction between the visible and nonvisible pastimes. The apostle Jéva Gosvámé in his commentary on this çloka as well as in the gloss of Ujjvala-nélamaëi and in Kåñëa-sandarbha remarks that “the visible pastimes of Kåñëa are the creation of His cit (spiritual) potency. Being in conjunction with the reference to mundane function they exhibit certain features which seem to be true by the influence of the limiting potency (Mäyā); but these cannot exist in the transcendental reality. The destruction of demons, illicit paramourship, birth, etc., are examples of this peculiarity. The gopés are the extensions of the ecstatic energy of Kåñëa, and so are exceptionally His own. How can there be illicit connection in their case? The illicit mistressship of the gopés found in His visible pastime, is but the mundane reflection of the transcendental reality.” The hidden meaning underlying the words of Çré Jéva Gosvámé, when it is made explicit, will leave no doubt in the minds of the readers. Çré Jéva Gosvámé is our preacher of transcendental truth. So he is always under the influence of Çré Rüpa and Sanātana. Moreover in the pastimes of Kåñëa Çré Jéva is one of the maijarés. So he is conversant with all transcendental realities.

There are some who, being unable to understand the drift of his statements, give meanings of their own invention and indulge in useless controversies. Çré Rüpa and Sanātana say that there is no real and essential distinction between the léläs visible and nonvisible, the only distinction lies in this that one is manifest in the mundane sphere whereas the other is not so. In the supermundane manifestation there is absolute purity in the seer and the seen. A particularly fortunate person when he is favored by Kåñëa, can shake off worldly shackles and connections, enter the transcendental region after attaining the realized taste of the varieties of rasa that is available during the period of novitiate. Only such a person can have a view and taste of the perfect and absolutely pure lélä of Goloka. Such receptive natures are rarely to be found. He, who exists in the mundane sphere, can also realize the taste of cid-rasa by the grace of Kåñëa by being enabled to attain the realized state of service. Such a person can have a view of the pastimes of Goloka manifested in the mundane lélä of Gokula. There is certainly a difference between these two classes of eligible seekers of the truth. Until one attains the perfectly transcendental stage he must be hampered by his lingering limitations, in his vision of the pastimes of

Goloka. Again, the vision of the transcendental reality varies according to the degree of self-realization. The vision of Goloka must also vary accordingly.

It is only those fettered souls who are excessively addicted to worldliness that are devoid of the devotional eye. Of them some are enmeshed by the variegatedness of the deluding energy while others aspire after self-annihilation under the influence of centrifugal knowledge. Though they might have a view of the mundanely manifested pastimes of the Supreme Lord, they can have only a material conception of those visible pastimes, this conception being devoid of transcendental reality. Hence the realization of Goloka appears in proportion to eligibility due to the degree of one's self-realization. The underlying principle is this, that, though Gokula is as holy and free from dross as Goloka, still it is manifested on the mundane plane by the influence of the cit potency. Yogamāyā. In visible and nonvisible matters of transcendental regions there is no impurity. contamination and imperfection inherent in the world of limitation; only there is some difference in the matter of realization in proportion to the self-realization of the seekers after the Absolute. Impurity. unwholesomeness, foreign elements, illusion, nescience, unholiness, utter inadequacy. insignificance, grossness—these appertain to the eye, intellect, mind and ego stultified by the material nature of conditioned souls; they have nothing to do with the essential nature of transcendence. The more one is free from these blots the more is one capable of realizing the unqualified Absolute. The truth who has been revealed by the scriptures, is free from dross. But the realizations of the seekers of the knowledge of these realities, are with or without flaw in accordance with the degree of their individual realization.

Those sixty-four arts that have been enumerated above, do in reality exist unstintedly only in Goloka. Unwholesomeness, insignificance, grossness are found in those arts in accordance with the degree of self-realization on the part of aspirants after the knowledge of the Absolute. According to Çréla Rūpa and Çréla Sanātana all those pastimes, that have been visible in Gokula, exist in all purity and free from all tinge of limitation in Goloka. So transcendental autocratic paramourship also exists in Goloka in inconceivable purity, judged by the same standard and reasoning. All

manifestation by the cit potency. Yogamāyā, are pure. So, as the above paramourship is the creation of Yogamāyā, it is necessarily free from all contamination, and appertains to the absolute reality.

Let us pause to consider what the absolute reality is in Himself. Çré Rūpa Gosvāmé says, pūrvokta-... sārataù. In regard to these çlokaç Çrépāda Jéva Gosvāmé after mature deliberation has established the transcendental paramourship as vibhrama-vilāsa, something seemingly different from what it appears to be; such are the pastimes of birth, etc., accomplished by Yogamāyā.

By the explanation tathāpi... vraja-vanitānām, Çréla Jéva Gosvāmé has expressed his profound implication. Joyous pastimes by the medium of seeming error, vibhrama-vilāsa, as the contrivance of Yogamāyā, has also been admitted in the concluding statements of Rūpa and Sanātana. Still, since Çrépāda Jéva Gosvāmé has established the identity of Goloka with Gokula, it must be admitted that there is transcendental reality underlying all the pastimes of Gokula. A husband is one who binds oneself in wedlock with a girl, while a paramour is one who, in order to win another's wife's love by means of love, crosses the conventions of morality. by the impulse of the sentiment that regards her love as the be-all and end-all of existence. In Goloka there is no such function at all as that of the nuptial relationship. Hence there is no husbandhood characterized by such connection. On the other hand since the gopés, who are self-supported real entities are not tied to anybody else in wedlock, they cannot also have the state of concubinage. There can also be no separate entities in the forms of svakéya (conjugal) and parakéya (adulterous) states. In the visible pastimes on the mundane plane the function in the form of the nuptial relationship is found to exist. Kāñëa is beyond the scope of that function. Hence the said function of the circle of all-love is contrived by Yogamāyā. Kāñëa tastes the transcendental rasa akin to paramourship by overstepping that function. This pastime of going beyond the pale of the apparent moral function manifested by Yogamāyā, is, however, also observable only on the mundane plane by the eye that is enwrapped by the mundane covering; but there is really no such levity in the pastimes of Kāñëa. The rasa of paramourship is certainly the extracted essence of all the rasas. If it be said that it does not exist in Goloka, it would be highly deprecatory to Goloka. It

is not the fact that there is no supremely wholesome tasting of rasa in the supremely excellent realm of Goloka. Kåñëa, the fountainhead of all avatāras, tastes the same in a distinct form in Goloka and in another distinct form in Gokula. Therefore, in spite of the seeming appearance, to the mundane eye, of outstepping the bounds of the legitimate function by the form of paramourship, there must be present the truth of it in some form even in Goloka. Ätmärāmo 'py aréramat, ätmany avaruddha-saurataù, reme vraja-sundarébhir yathärbhakaù pratibimba-vibhramaù and other texts of the scriptures go to show that self-delightedness is the essential distinctive quality of Kåñëa Himself. Kåñëa in His majestic cit realm causes the manifestation of His own cit potency as Lakñmé and enjoys her as His own wedded consort. As this feeling of wedded consorhood preponderates there, rasa expands in a wholesome form only up to the state of servanthood (däsya-rasa). But in Goloka He divides up His cit potency into thousands of gopés and eternally engages in amorous pastimes with them by forgetting the sentiments of ownership. By the sentiments of ownership there cannot be the extreme inaccessibility of the rasa. So the gopés have naturally, from eternity, the innate sentiment of being others' wedded wives. Kåñëa too in response to that sentiment, by assuming the reciprocal sentiment of paramourship, performs the räsa and the other amorous pastimes with the aid of the flute, His favorite cher ami. Goloka is the transcendental seat of eternally self-realized rasa, beyond limited conception. Hence in Goloka there is realization of the sentimental assumption of the rasa of paramourship.

Again such is the nature of the principle of the majesty that in the realm of Vaikuëöha there is no rasa of parental affection towards the source of all avatāras. But in Goloka, the seat of all superexcellent deliciousness, there is no more than the original sentimental egoistic assumption of the same rasa. There Nanda and Yaçodä are visibly present, but there is no occurrence of birth. For want of the occurrence of birth the assumed egoistic sentiment of parental affection of Nanda and Yaçodä has no foundation in the actual existence of such entities as father and mother, but it is of the nature of sentimental assumption on their parts, cf. jayati jana-niväso devaké-janma-vädaù, etc. For the purpose of the realization of the rasa the assumed egoistic sentiment is, however, eternal. In the rasa of amorous love if the corresponding egoistic sentiments of concubinage and

paramourship be mere eternal assumptions there is nothing to blame in them and it also does not go against the scriptures. When those transcendental entities of Goloka becomes manifest in Vraja then those two egoistic sentiments become somewhat more palpable to the mundane view in the phenomenal world and there comes to be this much difference only. In the rasa of parental affection the sentiments of Nanda and Yaçodä that they are parents becomes manifest in the more tangible form in the pastimes of birth etc., and in the amorous rasa the corresponding sentiments of concubinage in the respective gopés become manifest in the forms of their marriages with Abhimanyu, Govardhana, etc. In reality there is no such separate entity as husbandhood of the gopés either in Goloka or in Gokula. Hence the çästras declare that there is no sexual union of the gopés with their husbands. It is also for the same reason that the authorized teacher of the principle of rasa, Çré Rüpa, writes that in the transcendental amorous rasa the hero is of two different types, viz., the wedded husband and the paramour—patiç copapatiç ceti prabhedäv iha viçrutäv iti. Çré Jéva, in his commentary by his words patiù pura-vanitänää dvitéyo vraja-vanitänäm, acknowledges the eternal paramourship of Kåñëa in Goloka and Gokula and the husbandhood of Kåñëa in Vaikuëoha and Dväarakä etc. In the Lord of Goloka and the Lord of Gokula the character of paramourship is found in its complete form. Kåñëa's deliberate overstepping of His own quality of self-delightedness is caused by the desire of union with another's wedded wife. The state of being another's wedded wife is nothing but the corresponding assumed sentiment on the part of the gopés. In reality they have no husbands with independent and separate existence; still their very egoistic sentiment makes them have the nature of the wedded wives of others. So all the characteristics, viz., that "desire makes the paramour overstep the bounds of duty." etc., are eternally present in the seat of all "deliciousness." In Vraja that very thing reveals itself, to an extent, in a form more tangible to persons with mundane eyes.

So in Goloka there is inconceivable distinction and nondistinction between the rasas analogous to mundane concubineship and wifehood. It may be said with equal truth that there is no distinction in Goloka between the two as also that there is such distinction. The essence of paramourship is the cessation of ownership and the abeyance of ownership is the

enjoyment of His own cit potency in the shape of abeyance of paramourship or enjoyment without the sanction of wedlock. The conjunction of the two exists there as one rasa accommodating both varieties. In Gokula it is really the same with the difference that it produces a different impression on observers belonging to the mundane plane. In Govinda, the hero of Goloka, there exist both husbandhood and paramourship above all piety and impiety and free from all grossness. Such is also the case with the hero of Gokula although there is a distinction in realization caused by Yogamāyā. If it be urged that what is manifested by Yogamāyā is the highest truth being the creation of the cit potency and that, therefore, the impression of paramourship is also really true, the reply is that there may exist an impression of analogous sentimental egoism in the tasting of rasa free from any offense because it is not without a basis in truth. But the unwholesome impression that is produced in the mundane judgment is offensive and as such cannot exist in the pure cit realm. In fact Çrēpāda Jēva Gosvāmē has come to the true conclusion, and at the same time the finding of the opposing party is also inconceivably true. It is the vain empirical wranglings about wedded wifehood and concubinage which is false and full of specious verbosity. He who goes through the commentaries of Çrēpāda Jēva Gosvāmē and those of the opposing party with an impartial judgment cannot maintain his attitude of protest engendered by any real doubt. What the unalloyed devotee of the Supreme Lord says is all true and is independent of any consideration of unwholesome pros and cons. There is, however, the element of mystery in their verbal controversies. Those, whose judgment is made of mundane stuff, being unable to enter into the spirit of the all-loving controversies among pure devotees, due to their own want of unalloyed devotion, are apt to impute to the devotees their own defects of partisanship and opposing views. Commenting on the çloka of Rāsa-paīcādhyaē, gopēnāa tat-patēnāa ca, etc., what Çrēpāda Sanātana Gosvāmē has stated conclusively in his Vaiñēava-toñāēē has been accepted with reverence by the true devotee Çrēpāda Viçvanātha Cakravartē without any protest.

Whenever any dispute arises regarding the pure cognitive pastimes, such as Goloka, etc., we would do well to remember the precious advice from the holy lips of Çrēmān Mahāprabhu and His associates, the Gosvāmés, viz., that the Truth Absolute is ever characterized by spiritual

variegatedness that transcends the variegatedness of mundane phenomena; but He is never featureless. The divine rasa is lovely with the variegatedness of the fourfold distinction of vibhāva, anubhāva, sāttvika and vyabhicāri and the rasa is ever present in Goloka and Vaikuṇṭha. The rasa of Goloka manifests as vraja-rasa on the mundane plane for the benefit of the devotees by the power of Yogamāyā. Whatever is observable in gokula-rasa should be visible in goloka-rasa, in a clearly explicit form. Hence the distinction of paramourship and concubinage, the variegatedness of the respective rasas of all different persons, the soil, water, river, hill, portico, bower, cows, etc., all the features of Gokula exist in Goloka, disposed in an appropriate manner. There is only this peculiarity that the mundane conceptions of human beings possessed of material judgment, regarding those transcendental entities, do not exist there. The conception of Goloka manifests itself differently in proportion to the degree of realization of the various pastimes of Vraja and it is very difficult to lay down any definite criterion as to which portions are mundane and which are uncontaminated. The more the eye of devotion is tinged with the salve of love, the more will the transcendental concept gradually manifest itself. So there is no need of further hypothetical speculation which does not improve one's spiritual appreciation, as the substantive knowledge of Goloka is an inconceivable entity. To try to pursue the inconceivable by the conceptual process is like pounding the empty husk of grain, which is sure to have a fruitless ending. It is, therefore, one's bounden duty. by refraining from the endeavor to know, to try to gain the experience of the transcendental by the practice of pure devotion. Any course, the adoption of which tends to produce the impression of featurelessness, must be shunned by all means. Unalloyed parakēya-rasa free from all mundane conception is a most rare attainment. It is this which has been described in the narrative of the pastimes of Gokula. Those devotees, who follow the dictate of their pure spontaneous love, should base their devotional endeavors on that narrative. They will attain to the more wholesome fundamental principle on reaching the stage of realization. The devotional activities characterized by illicit amour, as practiced by worldly-minded conditioned souls, are forbidden mundane impiety. The heart of our apostle Ṣrēpāda Jēva Gosvāmē was very much moved by such practices and induced him to give us his conclusive statements on the subject. It is the duty of a pure Vaiñēava to accept the real spirit of his statements. It is a

great offense to disrespect the äcärya and to seek to establish a different doctrine in opposition to him.

Bs 5.38

TEXT 38

TEXT

premäïjana-cchurita-bhakti-vilocanena

santaù sadaiva hãdayeñu vilokayanti

yaà çyãmasundaram acintya-guëa-svarüpaà

govindam ädi-puruñaà tam ahaà bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

prema—of love; aïjana—with the salve; churita—tinged; bhakti—of devotion; vilocanena—with the eye; santaù—the pure devotees; sadä—always; eva—indeed; hãdayeñu—in their hearts; vilokayanti—see; yam—whom; çyãma—dark blue; sundaram—beautiful; acintya—inconceivable; guëa—with attributes; svarüpa—whose nature is endowed; govindam—Govinda; ädi-puruñam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajāmi—worship.

TRANSLATION

I worship Govinda, the primeval Lord, who is Çyãmasundara, Kãñëa Himself with inconceivable innumerable attributes, whom the pure devotees see in their heart of hearts with the eye of devotion tinged with the salve of love.

PURPORT

The Çyāmasundara form of Kāñḥā is His inconceivable simultaneous personal and impersonal self-contradictory form. True devotees see that form in their purified hearts under the influence of devotional trance. The form Çyāma is not the blue color visible in the mundane world but is the transcendental variegated color affording eternal bliss, and is not visible to the mortal eye. On a consideration of the trance of Vyāsadeva as in the ṣloka, bhakti-yogena manasi etc., it will be clear that the form of Çré Kāñḥā is the full Personality of Godhead and can only be visible in the heart of a true devotee, which is the only true seat in the state of trance under the influence of devotion. When Kāñḥā manifested Himself in Vraja, both the devotees and nondevotees saw Him with this very eye; but only the devotees cherished Him, eternally present in Vraja, as the priceless jewel of their heart. Nowadays also the devotees see Him in Vraja in their hearts, saturated with devotion although they do not see Him with their eyes. The eye of devotion is nothing but the eye of the pure unalloyed spiritual self of the jéva. The form of Kāñḥā is visible to that eye in proportion to its purification by the practice of devotion. When the devotion of the neophyte reaches the stage of bhāva-bhakti the pure eye of that devotee is tinged with the salve of love by the grace of Kāñḥā, which enables him to see Kāñḥā face to face. The phrase “in their hearts” means Kāñḥā is visible in proportion as their hearts are purified by the practice of devotion. The sum and substance of this ṣloka is that the form of Kāñḥā, who is Çyāmasundara, Naöavara (Best Dancer), Muralédhara (Holder of the Flute) and Tribhaiga (Triple-bending), is not a mental concoction but is transcendental, and is visible with the eye of the soul of the devotee under trance.

Bs 5.39

TEXT 39

TEXT

rāmādi-mūrtiṇu kalā-niyamena tiñöhan

nānāvatāram akarod bhuvaneṇu kintu

kåñëaù svayaà samabhavat paramaù pumän yo

govindam ädi-puruñaà tam ahaà bhajämi

SYNONYMS

räma-ädi—the incarnation of Lord Räma, etc.; mürtiñu—in different forms; kalä-niyamena—by the order of plenary portions; tiñöhan—existing; nänä—various; avatäram—incarnations; akarot—executed; bhuvaneñu—within the worlds; kintu—but; kåñëaù—Lord Kåñëa; svayam—personally; samabhavat—appeared; paramaù—the supreme; pumän—person; yaù—who; govindam—Govinda; ädi-puruñam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajämi—worship.

TRANSLATION

I worship Govinda, the primeval Lord, who manifested Himself personally as Kåñëa and the different avatäras in the world in the forms of Räma, Näsiaha, Vämana, etc., as His subjective portions.

PURPORT

His subjective portions as the avatäras, viz., Räma, etc., appear from Vaikuëöha and His own form Kåñëa manifests Himself with Vraja in this world, from Goloka. The underlying sense is that Kåñëa Caitanya, identical with Kåñëa Himself, also brings about by His appearance the direct manifestation of Godhead Himself.

Bs 5.40

TEXT 40

TEXT

yasya prabhä prabhavato jagad-aëöa-koöi-

koöiñv açeña-vasudhädi vibhüti-bhinnam

tad brahma niñkalam anantam aṇeña-bhūtaà

govindam ädi-puruñaà tam ahaà bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

yasya—of whom; prabhā—the effulgence; prabhavataù—of one who excels in power; jagat-aëòà—of universes; koöi-koöiñu—in millions and millions; aṇeña—unlimited; vasudhā-ädi—with planets and other manifestations; vibhūti—with opulences; bhinnam—becoming variegated; tat—that; brahma—Brahman; niñkalam—without parts; anantam—unlimited; aṇeña-bhūtam—being complete; govindam—Govinda; ädi-puruñam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajāmi—worship.

TRANSLATION

I worship Govinda, the primeval Lord, whose effulgence is the source of the nondifferentiated Brahman mentioned in the Upaniñads, being differentiated from the infinity of glories of the mundane universe appears as the indivisible, infinite, limitless, truth.

PURPORT

The mundane universe created by Mäyā is one of the infinite external manifestations accommodating space, time and gross things. The impersonal aspect of Godhead, the nondifferentiated Brahman, is far above this principle of mundane creation. But even the nondifferentiated Brahman is only the external effulgence emanating from the boundary wall of the transcendental realm of Vaikuëòha displaying the triquadrantal glory of Govinda. The nondifferentiated Brahman is indivisible, hence is also one without a second, and is the infinite, and residual entity.

Bs 5.41

TEXT 41

TEXT

mäyā hi yasya jagad-aëòà-çatāni sūte

traiguëya-tad-viñaya-veda-vitāyamānā

sattvāvalambi-para-sattvaà viçuddha-sattvam-

govindam ādi-puruñāà tam ahaà bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

mäyā—the external potency; hi—indeed; yasya—of whom; jagat-aëòà—of universes; çatāni—hundreds; sūte—brings forth; trai-guëya—embodying the threefold mundane qualities; tat—of that; viñaya—the subject matter; veda—the Vedic knowledge; vitāyamānā—diffusing; sattva-avalambi—the support of all existence; para-sattvam—the ultimate entity; viçuddha-sattvam—the absolute substantive principle; govindam—Govinda; ādi-puruñam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajāmi—worship.

TRANSLATION

I worship Govinda, the primeval Lord, who is the absolute substantive principle being the ultimate entity in the form of the support of all existence whose external potency embodies the threefold mundane qualities, viz., sattva, rajas, and tamas and diffuses the Vedic knowledge regarding the mundane world.

PURPORT

The active mundane quality of rajas brings forth or generates all mundane entities. The quality of sattva (mundane manifestive principle) in conjunction with rajas stands for the maintenance of the existence of entities that are so produced, and the quality of tamas represents the principle of destruction. The substantive principle, which is mixed with the threefold mundane qualities, is mundane, while the unmixed substance is transcendental. The quality of eternal existence is the principle of absolute entity. The person whose proper form abides in that essence, is alone unalloyed entity. nonmundane, supermundane and free from all mundane

quality. He is cognitive bliss. It is the deluding energy who has elaborated the regulative knowledge (Vedas) bearing on the threefold mundane quality.

Bs 5.42

TEXT 42

TEXT

änanda-cinmaya-rasätmatayä manaùsu

yaù präëinää pratiphalan smaratäm upetya

léläyitena bhuvanäni jayaty ajasram-

govindam ädi-puruñaa tam ahaà bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

änanda—blissful; cit-maya—cognitive; rasa—of rasa; ätmatayä—due to being the entity; manaùsu—in the minds; yaù—He who; präëinäm—of living entities; pratiphalan—being reflected; smaratäm upetya—recollecting; léläyitena—by pastimes; bhuvanäni—the mundane world; jayati—triumphantly dominates; ajasram—ever; govindam—Govinda; ädi-puruñam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajāmi—worship.

TRANSLATION

I worship Govinda, the primeval Lord, whose glory ever triumphantly dominates the mundane world by the activity of His own pastimes, being reflected in the mind of recollecting souls as the transcendental entity of ever-blissful cognitive rasa.

PURPORT

Those who constantly recollect in accordance with spiritual instructions

the name, figure, attributes and pastimes of the form of Kåñëa appearing in the amorous rasa, whose loveliness vanquishes the god of mundane love, conqueror of all mundane hearts, are alone meditators of Kåñëa. Kåñëa, who is full of pastimes, always manifests Himself with His realm only in the pure receptive cognition of such persons. The pastimes of that manifested divine realm triumphantly dominates in every way all the majesty and beauty of the mundane world.

Bs 5.43

TEXT 43

TEXT

goloka-nämni nija-dhämni tale ca tasya

devi maheça-hari-dhāmasu teñu teñu

te te prabhāva-nicayā vihitāç ca yena

govindam ädi-puruññaà tam ahaà bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

goloka-nämni—in the planet known as Goloka Våndävana; nija-dhämni—the personal abode of the Supreme Personality of Godhead; tale—in the part underneath; ca—also; tasya—of that; devi—of the goddess Durgä; maheça—of Lord Çiva; hari—of Näräyaëa; dhāmasu—in the planets; teñu teñu—in each of them; te te—those respective; prabhāva-nicayäù—opulences; vihitäù—established; ca—also; yena—by whom; govindam—Govinda; ädi-puruñnam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajāmi—worship.

TRANSLATION

Lowest of all is located Devé-dhāma [mundane world], next above it is Maheça-dhāma [abode of Maheça]; above Maheça-dhāma is placed Hari-

dhäma [abode of Hari] and above them all is located Kåñëa's own realm named Goloka. I adore the primeval Lord Govinda, who has allotted their respective authorities to the rulers of those graded realms.

PURPORT

The realm of Goloka stands highest above all others. Brahmä looking up to the higher position of Goloka is speaking of the other realms from the point of view of his own realm: the first in order is this mundane world called Devé-dhäma consisting of the fourteen worlds, viz., Satyaloka, etc.; next above Devé-dhäma is located Çiva-dhäma one portion of which, called Mahäkäla-dhäma, is enveloped in darkness; interpenetrating this portion of Çiva-dhäma there shines the Sadäçivaloka, full of great light. Above the same appears Hari-dhäma or the transcendental Vaikuëöhaloka. The potency of Devé-dhäma, in the form of the extension of Mäyä, and that of Çivaloka, consisting of time, space and matter, are the potency of the separated particles pervaded by the penumbral reflection of the subjective portion of the Divinity. But Hari-dhäma is ever resplendent with transcendental majesty and the great splendor of all-sweetness predominates over all other majesties in Goloka. The Supreme Lord Govinda by his own direct and indirect power has constituted those respective potencies of those realms.

Bs 5.44

TEXT 44

TEXT

sãñöi-sthiti-pralaya-sädhana-çaktir ekä

chäyeva yasya bhuvanäni bibharti durgä

icchänurüpam api yasya ca ceñöate sä

govindam ädi-puruñaà tam ahaà bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

sāññi—creation; sthiti—preservation; pralaya—and destruction; sādhana—the agency; çakti—potency; ekā—one; chāyā—the shadow; iva—like; yasya—of whom; bhuvanāni—the mundane world; bibharti—maintains; durgā—Durgā; icchā—the will; anurūpam—in accordance with; api—certainly; yasya—of whom; ca—and; ceññate—conducts herself; sā—she; govindam—Govinda; ādi-puruṇam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajāmi—worship.

TRANSLATION

The external potency Māyā who is of the nature of the shadow of the cit potency, is worshiped by all people as Durgā, the creating, preserving and destroying agency of this mundane world. I adore the primeval Lord Govinda in accordance with whose will Durgā conducts herself.

PURPORT

(The aforesaid presiding deity of Devé-dhāma is being described.) The world, in which Brahmā takes his stand and hymns the Lord of Goloka, is Devé-dhāma consisting of the fourteen worlds and Durgā is its presiding deity. She is ten-armed, representing the tenfold fruitive activities. She rides on the lion, representing her heroic prowess. She tramples down Mahéñāsura, representing the subduer of vices. She is the mother of two sons, Kārttikeya and Gaëeça, representing beauty and success. She is placed between Lakñmé and Sarasvaté, representing mundane opulence and mundane knowledge. She is armed with the twenty weapons, representing the various pious activities enjoined by the Vedas for suppression of vices. She holds the snake, representing the beauty of destructive time. Such is Durgā possessing all these manifold forms. Durgā is possessed of durga, which means a prison house. When jévas begotten of the marginal potency (taöasthä çakti) forget the service of Kāññea they are confined in the mundane prison house, the citadel of Durgā. The wheel of karma is the instrument of punishment at this place. The work of purifying these penalized jévas is the duty devolved upon Durgā. She is incessantly engaged in discharging the same by the will of Govinda. When, luckily, the

forgetfulness of Govinda on the part of imprisoned jévas is remarked by them by coming in contact with self-realized souls and their natural aptitude for the loving service of Kåñëa is aroused, Durgä herself then becomes the agency of their deliverance by the will of Govinda. So it behooves everybody to obtain the guileless grace of Durgä, the mistress of this prison house, by propitiating her with the selfless service of Kåñëa. The boons received from Durgä in the shape of wealth, property, recovery from illness, of wife and sons, should be realized as the deluding kindness of Durgä. The mundane psychical jubilations of daça-mahä-vidyā, the ten goddesses or forms of Durgä, are elaborated for the delusion of the fettered souls of this world. Jéva is a spiritual atomic part of Kåñëa. When he forgets his service of Kåñëa he is at once deflected by the attracting power of Mäyā in this world, who throws him into the whirlpool of mundane fruitive activity (karma) by confining him in a gross body constituted by the five material elements, their five attributes and eleven senses, resembling the garb of a prisoner. In this whirlpool jéva has experience of happiness and miseries, heaven and hell. Besides this, there is a subtle body. consisting of the mind, intelligence and ego, inside the gross body. By means of the subtle body. the jéva forsakes one gross body and takes recourse to another. The jéva cannot get rid of the subtle body. full of nescience and evil desires, unless and until he is liberated. On getting rid of the subtle body he bathes in the Virajā and goes up to Hari-dhāma. Such are the duties performed by Durgä in accordance with the will of Govinda. In the Bhāgavata çloka, vilajyamānayā... durdhiyaù—the relationship between Durgä and the conditioned souls has been described.

Durgä, worshiped by the people of this mundane world, is the Durgä described above. But the spiritual Durgä, mentioned in the mantra which is the outer covering of the spiritual realm of the Supreme Lord, is the eternal maidservant of Kåñëa and is, therefore, the transcendental reality whose shadow, the Durgä of this world, functions in this mundane world as her maidservant. (Vide the purport of çloka 3.)

Bs 5.45

TEXT 45

TEXT

kñéraà yathä dadhi vikära-viçeña-yogät

saijãyate na hi tataù pãthag asti hetoù

yaù çambhutäm api tathä samupaiti käryäd

govindam ädi-puruñaà tam ahaà bhajämi

SYNONYMS

kñéram—milk; yathä—as; dadhi—yogurt; vikära-viçeña—of a special transformation; yogät—by the application; saijãyate—is transformed into; na—not; hi—indeed; tataù—from the milk; pãthak—separated; asti—is; hetoù—which is the cause; yaù—who; çambhutäm—the nature of Lord Çiva; api—also; tathä—thus; samupaiti—accepts; käryät—for the matter of some particular business; govindam—Govinda; ädi-puruñam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajämi—worship.

TRANSLATION

Just as milk is transformed into curd by the action of acids, but yet the effect curd is neither same as, nor different from, its cause, viz., milk, so I adore the primeval Lord Govinda of whom the state of Çambhu is a transformation for the performance of the work of destruction.

PURPORT

(The real nature of Çambhu, the presiding deity of Maheça-dhäma, is described.) Çambhu is not a second Godhead other than Kãñëa. Those, who entertain such discriminating sentiment, commit a great offense against the Supreme Lord. The supremacy of Çambhu is subservient to that of Govinda; hence they are not really different from each other. The nondistinction is established by the fact that just as milk treated with acid turns into curd so Godhead becomes a subservient when He Himself attains a distinct personality by the addition of a particular element of adulteration. This

personality has no independent initiative. The said adulterating principle is constituted of a combination of the stupefying quality of the deluding energy, the quality of nonplenitude of the marginal potency and a slight degree of the ecstatic-cum-cognitive principle of the plenary spiritual potency. This specifically adulterated reflection of the principle of the subjective portion of the Divinity is Sadāçiva, in the form of the effulgent masculine-symbol-god Çambhu from whom Rudradeva is manifested. In the work of mundane creation as the material cause, in the work of preservation by the destruction of sundry asuras and in the work of destruction to conduct the whole operation, Govinda manifests Himself as guëa-avatāra in the form of Çambhu who is the separated portion of Govinda imbued with the principle of His subjective plenary portion. The personality of the destructive principle in the form of time has been identified with that of Çambhu by scriptural evidences that have been adduced in the commentary. The purport of the Bhāgavata çlokas, viz., vaiñëavānāà yathā çambhuù, etc., is that Çambhu, in pursuance of the will of Govinda, works in union with his consort Durgādevé by his own time energy. He teaches pious duties (dharma) as stepping-stones to the attainment of spiritual service in the various tantra-çāstras, etc., suitable for jévas in different grades of the conditional existence. In obedience to the will of Govinda, Çambhu maintains and fosters the religion of pure devotion by preaching the cult of illusionism (Māyāvāda) and the speculative āgama-çāstras. The fifty attributes of individual souls are manifest in a far vaster measure in Çambhu and five additional attributes not attainable by jévas are also partly found in him. So Çambhu cannot be called a jéva. He is the lord of jéva but yet partakes of the nature of a separated portion of Govinda.

Bs 5.46

TEXT 46

TEXT

dépārcir eva hi daçāntaram abhyupetya

dépāyate vivāta-hetu-samāna-dharmā

yas tādāg eva hi ca viññutayā vibhāti

govindam ādi-puruṇāa tam ahaa bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

dēpa-arcīu—the flame of a lamp; eva—as; hi—certainly; daṇḍa-antaram—another lamp; abhyupetya—expanding; dēpāyate—illuminates; vivāta-hetu—with its expanded cause; samāna-dharmā—equally powerful; yaū—who; tādāka—similarly; eva—indeed; hi—certainly; ca—also; viññutayā—by His expansion as Lord Viññu; vibhāti—illuminates; govindam—Govinda; ādi-puruṇam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajāmi—worship.

TRANSLATION

The light of one candle being communicated to other candles, although it burns separately in them, is the same in its quality. I adore the primeval Lord Govinda who exhibits Himself equally in the same mobile manner in His various manifestations.

PURPORT

The presiding Deities of Hari-dhāma, viz., Hari, Nārāyaṇa, Viññu, etc., the subjective portions of Kāṇḍa, are being described. The majestic manifestation of Kāṇḍa is Nārāyaṇa, Lord of Vaikuṇṭha, whose subjective portion is Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viññu, the prime cause, whose portion is Garbhodakaśāyī. Kṣīrodakaśāyī is again the subjective portion of Garbhodakaśāyī Viññu. The word “Viññu” indicates all-pervading, omnipresent and omniscient personality. In this śloka the activities of the subjective portions of the Divinity are enunciated by the specification of the nature of Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viññu. The personality of Viññu, the embodied form of the manifestive quality (sattva-guṇa) is quite distinct from that of Ṣaṁbhu who is adulterated with mundane qualities. Viññu’s subjective personality is on a level with that of Govinda. Both consist of the unadulterated substantive principle. Viññu in the form of the manifest causal principle is identical with Govinda as regards quality. The manifestive

quality (sattva-guëa) that is found to exist in the triple mundane quality, is an adulterated entity. being alloyed with the qualities of mundane activity and inertia. Brahmä is the dislocated portion of the Divinity. manifested in the principle of mundane action, endowed with the functional nature of His subjective portion; and Çambhu is the dislocated portion of the Divinity manifested in the principle of mundane inertia possessing similarly the functional nature of His subjective portion. The reason for their being dislocated portions is that the two principles of mundane action and inertia being altogether wanting in the spiritual essence any entities, that are manifested in them, are located at a great distance from the Divinity Himself or His facsimiles. Although the mundane manifestive quality is of the adulterated kind, Viñëu, the manifestation of the Divinity in the mundane manifestive quality. makes His appearance in the unadulterated manifestive principle which is a constituent of the mundane manifestive quality. Hence Viñëu is the full subjective portion and belongs to the category of the superior éçvaras. He is the Lord of the deluding potency and not alloyed with her. Viñëu is the agent of Govinda's own subjective nature in the form of the prime cause. All the majestic attributes of Govinda, aggregating sixty in number, are fully present in His majestic manifestation, Näräyaëa. Brahmä and Çiva are entities adulterated with mundane qualities. Though Viñëu is also divine appearance in mundane quality (guëa-avatära), still He is not adulterated. The appearance of Näräyaëa in the form of Mahä-Viñëu, the appearance of Mahä-Viñëu in the form of Garbhodakaçäyë and the appearance of Viñëu in the form of Kñërodakaçäyë, are examples of the ubiquitous function of the Divinity. Viñëu is Godhead Himself, and the two other guëa-avatäras and all the other gods are entities possessing authority in subordination to Him. From the subjective majestic manifestation of the supreme self-luminous Govinda emanate Käräëodakaçäyë, Garbhodakaçäyë, Kñërodakaçäyë and all other derivative subjective divine descents (avatäras) such as Räma, etc., analogous to communicated light appearing in different candles, shining by the operation of the spiritual potency of Govinda.

Bs 5.47

TEXT 47

TEXT

yaù kàràëärëava-jale bhajati sma yoga-
nidräm ananta-jagad-aëòa-sa-roma-küpaù
ädhàra-çaktim avalambya paräà sva-mürtià
govindam ädi-puruñaà tam ahaà bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

yaù—He who; kàràëa-arëava—of the Causal Ocean; jale—in the water; bhajati—enjoys; sma—indeed; yoga-nidräm—creative sleep; ananta—unlimited; jagat-aëòa—universes; sa—with; roma-küpaù—the pores of His hair; ädhàra-çaktim—the all-accommodating potency; avalambya—assuming; paräm—great; sva-mürtim—own subjective form; govindam—Govinda; ädi-puruñam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajāmi—worship.

TRANSLATION

I adore the primeval Lord Govinda who assuming His own great subjective form, who bears the name of Çeña, replete with the all-accommodating potency, and reposing in the Causal Ocean with the infinity of the world in the pores of His hair, enjoys creative sleep [yoga-nidrā].

PURPORT

(The subjective nature of Ananta who has the form of the couch of Mahā-Viñëu, is described.) Ananta, the same who is the infinite couch on which Mahā-Viñëu reposes, is a distinctive appearance of the Divinity bearing the name of Çeña, having the subjective nature of the servant of Kåñëa.

Bs 5.48

TEXT 48

TEXT

yasyaika-niçvasita-kālam athāvalambya

jévanti loma-vilajā jagad-aëòa-nāthäù

viñëur mahän sa iha yasya kalä-viçeño

govindam ädi-puruñaà tam ahaà bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

yasya—whose; eka—one; niçvasita—of breath; kālam—time; atha—thus; avalambya—taking shelter of; jévanti—live; loma-vila-jäù—grown from the hair holes; jagat-aëòa-nāthäù—the masters of the universes (the Brahmäs); viñëuù mahän—the Supreme Lord Mahä-Viñëu; saù—that; iha—here; yasya—whose; kalä-viçeñaù—particular plenary portion or expansion; govindam—Govinda; ädi-puruñam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajāmi—worship.

TRANSLATION

Brahmä and other lords of the mundane worlds, appearing from the pores of hair of Mahä-Viñëu, remain alive as long as the duration of one exhalation of the latter [Mahä-Viñëu]. I adore the primeval Lord Govinda of whose subjective personality Mahä-Viñëu is the portion of portion.

PURPORT

The supreme majesty of the subjective nature of Viñëu is shown here.

Bs 5.49

TEXT 49

TEXT

bhāsvān yathāçma-çakaleñu nijeñu tejaù

svéyam kiyat prakaöayaty api tadvad atra

brahmā ya eña jagad-aëòa-vidhāna-kartā

govindam ādi-puruñāa tam ahaa bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

bhāsvān—the illuminating sun; yathā—as; açma-çakaleñu—in various types of precious stones; nijeñu—his own; tejaù—brilliance; svéyam—his own; kiyat—to some extent; prakaöayati—manifests; api—also; tadvat—similarly; atra—here; brahmā—Lord Brahmā; yaù—who; eñaù—he; jagat-aëòa-vidhāna-kartā—the chief of the universe; govindam—Govinda; ādi-puruñam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajāmi—worship.

TRANSLATION

I adore the primeval Lord Govinda from whom the separated subjective portion Brahmā receives his power for the regulation of the mundane world, just as the sun manifests some portion of his own light in all the effulgent gems that bear the names of süryakānta, etc.

PURPORT

Brahmā is two types: in certain kalpas when the potency of the Supreme Lord infuses Himself in an eligible jéva, the latter acts in the office of Brahmā and creates the universe. In those kalpas when no eligible jéva is available, after the Brahmā of the previous kalpa is liberated, Kāñëa, by the process of allotment of His own potency, creates the Brahmā who has the nature of the avatāra (descent) of the Divinity in the active mundane principle (rajo-guëa). By principle Brahmā is superior to ordinary jévas but is not the direct Divinity. The divine nature is present in a greater measure in Çambhu than in Brahmā. The fundamental significance of the above is that

the aggregate of fifty attributes, belonging to the jéva, are present in a fuller measure in Brahmä who possesses, in a lesser degree, five more attributes which are not found in jévas. But in Çambhu both the fifty attributes of jévas as also the five additional attributes found in Brahmä are present in even greater measure than in Brahmä.

Bs 5.50

TEXT 50

TEXT

yat-pāda-pallava-yugaà vinidhāya kumbha-

dvandve praëäma-samaye sa gaëädhirājaù

vighnān vihan̄tum alam asya jagat-trayasya

govindam ādi-puruṇāà tam ahaà bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

yat—whose; pāda-pallava—lotus feet; yugam—two; vinidhāya—having held; kumbha-dvandve—upon the pair of tumuli; praëäma-samaye—at the time of offering obeisances; saù—he; gaëa-adhirājaù—Gaëeça; vighnān—obstacles; vihan̄tum—to destroy; alam—capable; asya—of these; jagat-trayasya—three worlds; govindam—Govinda; ādi-puruṇam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajāmi—worship.

TRANSLATION

I adore the primeval Lord Govinda, whose lotus feet are always held by Gaëeça upon the pair of tumuli protruding from his elephant head in order to obtain power for his function of destroying all the obstacles on the path of progress of the three worlds.

PURPORT

The power of destroying all obstacles to mundane prosperity has been delegated to Gaëeça who is the object of worship to those who are eligible to worship him. He has obtained a rank among the five gods as Brahmä possessing mundane quality. The self-same Gaëeça is a god in possession of delegated power by infusion of the divine power. All his glory rests entirely on the grace of Govinda.

Bs 5.51

TEXT 51

TEXT

agnir mahi gaganam ambu marud diçaç ca

kālas tathātma-manaséti jagat-trayäëi

yasmäd bhavanti vibhavanti viçanti yaà ca

govindam ädi-puruñaà tam ahaà bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

agniù—fire; mahi—earth; gaganam—ether; ambu—water; marut—air; diçaù—directions; ca—also; kälau—time; tathä—as well as; ätma—soul; manasé—and mind; iti—thus; jagat-trayäëi—the three worlds; yasmät—from whom; bhavanti—they originate; vibhavanti—they exist; viçanti—they enter; yam—whom; ca—also; govindam—Govinda; ädi-puruñam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajāmi—worship.

TRANSLATION

The three worlds are composed of the nine elements, viz., fire, earth, ether, water, air, direction, time, soul and mind. I adore the primeval Lord Govinda from whom they originate, in whom they exist and into whom they enter at the time of the universal cataclysm.

PURPORT

There is nothing in the three worlds save the five elements, ten quarters, time, jéva-soul, and the mental principle allied with the subtle body consisting of mind, intelligence and ego of conditioned souls. The elevationists (karmés) make their offerings in sacrifice in the fire. Conditioned souls know nothing beyond this perceptible world of nine elements. The jéva is the self-same soul whose ecstatic delight the joyless liberationists (jïänés) aspire after. Both the principles that are respectively depicted as ätmä and prakâti by the system of Säikhya are included in the above. In other words all the principles that have been enunciated by all the speculative philosophers (tattva-vädés) are included in these nine elements. Çré Govinda is the source of the appearance, continuance and subsidence of all these principles.

Bs 5.52

TEXT 52

TEXT

yac-cakñur eña savitā sakala-grahäëää

rājā samasta-sura-mūrtir aṇeña-tejäu

yasyäjäyā bhramati sambhāta-kāla-cakro

govindam ādi-puruṇāa tam ahaa bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

yat—of whom; cakñu—the eye; eña—the; savitā—sun; sakala-grahäëäm—of all the planets; rājā—the king; samasta-sura—of all the demigods; mūrti—the image; aṇeña-tejäu—full of infinite effulgence; yasya—of whom; äjäyā—by the order; bhramati—performs his journey; sambhāta—complete; kāla-cakra—the wheel of time; govindam—Govinda; ādi-puruṇam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I;

bhajämi—worship.

TRANSLATION

The sun who is the king of all the planets, full of infinite effulgence, the image of the good soul, is as the eye of this world. I adore the primeval Lord Govinda in pursuance of whose order the sun performs his journey mounting the wheel of time.

PURPORT

Certain professors of the Vedic religion worship the sun as Brahman. The sun is one of the hierarchy of the five gods. Some people target in heat the source of this world and therefore designate the sun, the only location of heat, as the root cause of this world. Notwithstanding all that may be said to the contrary, the sun is after all only the presiding deity of a sphere of the sum total of all mundane heat and is hence a god exercising delegated authority. The sun performs his specific function of service certainly by the command of Govinda.

Bs 5.53

TEXT 53

TEXT

dharmo 'tha päpa-nicayaù çrutayas tapäàsi

brahmädi-kéöa-patagävadhayaç ca jéväù

yad-datta-mätra-vibhava-prakaöa-prabhävä

govindam ädi-puruñaà tam ahaà bhajämi

SYNONYMS

dharmaù—virtue; atha—also; päpa-nicayaù—all vices; çrutayaù—the

Vedas; tapäasi—penances; brahma-ädi—beginning from Lord Brahmä; kéöa-pataga—insects; avadhayaù—down to; ca—and; jéväù—jévas; yat—by whom; datta—conferred; mätra—exclusively; vibhava—by the power; prakaöa—manifested; prabhäväù—potencies; govindam—Govinda; ädi-puruñam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajämi—worship.

TRANSLATION

I adore the primeval Lord Govinda, by whose conferred power are maintained the manifested potencies, that are found to exist, of all virtues, all vices, the Vedas, the penances and all jévas, from Brahmä to the meanest insect.

PURPORT

By dharma is meant the allotted functions of varëa and äçrama manifested by the twenty dharma-çästras on the authority of the Vedas. Of these two divisions varëa-dharma is that function which is the outcome of the distinctive natures of the four varëas, viz., brähmaëa, kñatriya, vaiçya and çüdra and äçrama-dharma is that function which is appropriate to the respective äçramas or stations of those who belong to the four stages, viz., brahmacarya, gâhastha, vânaprastha and sannyäsa. All customary activities of mankind have been targeted in these twofold divisions. Sins mean nescience, the root of all sins and sinful desire, also the greatest iniquities and sins flowing from them and the ordinary sins, i.e., all sorts of unprincipled conduct. The category of the çrutis means Åg, Säma, Yajur and Atharva and the Upaniñads which form the crest jewels of the Veda. The tapas mean all regular practices that are learnt with the view of the attainment of the proper function of the self. In many cases, e.g., in the form known as päica-tapas these practices are of a difficult character (yoga) with its eight constituents limbs and devotedness to the knowledge of the undifferentiated Brahman are included therein. All these are so many distinctive features within the revolving round of the fruitive activities of conditioned souls. The conditioned souls are embarked on a sojourn of successive births from 84 lakhs of varieties of generating organs. They are differentiated into different orders of beings as devas, dânavas, räkñasas, mänavas, nägas, kinnaras, and gandharvas. These jévas, from Brahmä down

to the small insect, are infinite in type. They make up the aggregate of the conditioned souls from the degree of Brahmā to that of the little fly and are the distinctive features within the revolving wheel of karma. Every one of them is endowed with distinctive powers as individuals and is powerful in a particular sphere. But these powers are by their nature not fully developed in them. The degree of power and nature of property vary according to the measure of manifestation of the possessions of the individual conferred upon him by Çré Govinda.

Bs 5.54

TEXT 54

TEXT

yas tv indragopam athavendram aho sva-karma-

bandhānurūpa-phala-bhājanam ātanoti

karmāēi nirdahati kintu ca bhakti-bhājā

govindam ādi-puruṇā tam aha bhajāmi

SYNONYMS

yaù—He who (Govinda); tu—but; indra-gopam—to the small red insect called indragopa; atha vā—or even; indram—to Indra, king of heaven; aho—oh; sva-karma—of one’s own fruitive activities; bandha—bondage; anurūpa—according to; phala—of reactions; bhājanam—enjoying or suffering; ātanoti—bestows; karmāēi—all fruitive activities and their reactions; nirdahati—destroys; kintu—but; ca—also; bhakti-bhājām—of persons engaged in devotional service; govindam—Govinda; ādi-puruṇām—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajāmi—worship.

TRANSLATION

I adore the primeval Lord Govinda, who burns up to their roots all

fruitive activities of those who are imbued with devotion and impartially ordains for each the due enjoyment of the fruits of one's activities, of all those who walk in the path of work, in accordance with the chain of their previously performed works, no less in the case of the tiny insect that bears the name of indragopa than in that of Indra, king of the devas.

PURPORT

God impartially induces the fallen souls to act in the way that is consequent on the deeds of their previous births and to enjoy the fruition of their labors but, out of His great mercy to His devotees, He purges out, by the fire of ordeal, the root of all karma, viz., nescience and evil desires. Karma, though without beginning, is still perishable. The karma of those, who work with the hope of enjoying the fruits of their labors, becomes everlasting and endless and is never destroyed. The function of sannyāsa is also a sort of karma befitting an āçrama and is not pleasant to Kåñëa when it aims at liberation, i.e., desire for emancipation. They also receive fruition of their karma and, even if it be disinterested, their karma ends in ātma-mamatā, i.e., self-pleasure; but those who are pure devotees always serve Kåñëa by gratifying His senses forsaking all attempts of karma and jñāna, and being free from all desires save that of serving Kåñëa. Kåñëa has fully destroyed the karma, its desires and nescience of those devotees. It is a great wonder that Kåñëa, being impartial, is fully partial to His devotees.

Bs 5.55

TEXT 55

TEXT

yaà krodha-kāma-sahaja-praëayādi-bhëti-

vātsalya-moha-guru-gaurava-sevya-bhāvaiù

saïcintya tasya sadāçéà tanum äpur ete

govindam ädi-puruññaà tam ahaà bhajämi

SYNONYMS

yam—upon whom; krodha—wrath; kāma—amorous passion; sahaja-praëaya—natural friendly love; ädi—and so on; bhéti—fear; vätsalya—parental affection; moha—delusion; guru-gaurava—reverence; sevya-bhävaiù—and with the attitude of willing service; säcintya—meditating; tasya—of that; sadâçém—befitting; tanum—bodily form; äpuù—attained; ete—these persons; govindam—Govinda; ädi-puruñam—the original person; tam—Him; aham—I; bhajämi—worship.

TRANSLATION

I adore the primeval Lord Govinda, the meditators of whom, by meditating upon Him under the sway of wrath, amorous passion, natural friendly love, fear, parental affection, delusion, reverence and willing service, attain to bodily forms befitting the nature of their contemplation.

PURPORT

Devotion is of two kinds, viz., (1) of the nature of deference to regulation and (2) constituted of natural feeling. Bhakti is roused by following with a tinge of faith in the rule of the çästras and instruction of the preceptors. Such bhakti is of the nature of loyalty to the scriptural regulations. It continues to be operative as long as the corresponding natural feeling is not roused. If a person loves Kåñëa out of natural tendency, there is the principle of räga, which is no other than a strong desire to serve, which turns into bhäva or substantive feeling. When the substantive feeling is aroused the devotee becomes an object of mercy of Kåñëa. It takes much time to attain this stage. Devotion which is of the nature of feeling is superior to that connected with scriptural regulation, soon attains to the realized state and is attractive to Kåñëa. Its various aspects are described in this çloka. Çänta-bhäva, full of reverence to superior, däsya-bhäva, full of service for carrying out the commands of the object of worship, sakhya-bhäva or natural friendly love, vätsalya-bhäva or parental affection and madhura-bhäva or amorous love, are all included in the category of devotion of the nature of instinctive attachment. But anger, fear and delusion, though they are of the nature of instinctive impulse, are

not devotion in the strict sense of the term, because they are not friendly but hostile to the object. Anger is found in asuras like Çiçupäla, fear in Kaàsa, and delusion in the paëòitas of the pantheistic school. They have the feelings of anger, fear and instinctive impulse marked by complete self-forgetful identification with the nondifferentiated Brahman. But as there is no friendly feeling towards the object of devotion there is no bhakti. Again among the feelings of çänta, däsya, sakhya, vätsalya and madhura—çänta, though indifferent and dormant in räga, is still reckoned as bhakti on account of its being a little friendly. There is an immense volume of räga in the other four varieties of emotion. By the promise of Gétä, ye yathä mäà prapadyante täàs tathaiva bhajämy aham [Bg. 4.11] (“I serve one according to his submission”), those, who allow themselves to be actuated by the sentiments of fear, anger and delusion, attain to säyujya-mukti (merging in the Absolute). The çäntas obtain bodily forms with aptitude for addiction to Brahman and Paramätmä. The däsya and sakhya classes of worshipers attain bodily forms characterized by masculine or feminine disposition according to their respective grades of eligibility. The vätsalya class of worshipers get bodily forms befitting fatherly and motherly sentiments. The amorous lovers of Kåñëa attain the pure forms of gopés (spiritual milkmaids of Vraja).

Bs 5.56

TEXT 56

TEXT

çriyaù kântäù kântaù parama-puruñaù kalpa-taravo

drumä bhümiç cintämaëi-gaëa-mayi toyam amâtam

kathä gänaà näöyaà gamanam api vaàçé priya-sakhi

cid-änandaà jyotiù param api tad äsvädyam api ca

sa yatra kñéräbdhiù sravati surabhébhyaç ca su-mahän

nimeñärdhäkhyo vä vrajati na hi yaträpi samayaù

bhaje çvetadvépaà tam aham iha golokam iti yaà

vidantas te santaù kñiti-virala-cäräù katipaye

SYNONYMS

çriyaù—Lakñmés, goddesses of fortune; kântäù—loving consorts; kântaù—the enjoyer, lover; parama-puruñaù—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; kalpa-taravaù—desire trees; drumäù—all the trees; bhümiù—the land; cintämaëi-gaëa-mayi—made of the transcendental touchstone jewels; toyam—the water; amâtam—nectar; kathä—talking; gänam—song; näöyam—dancing; gamanam—walking; api—also; vaàcé—the flute; priya-sakhé—constant companion; cit-änandam—transcendental bliss; jyotiù—effulgence; param—the supreme; api—also; tat—that; äsvädyam—everywhere perceived; api ca—also; saù—that; yatra—where; kñëra-abdhiù—ocean of milk; sravati—flows; surabhébhyaù—from surabhi cows; ca—and; su-mahän—very great; nimeña-ardha—half a moment; äkhyäù—called; vä—or; vrajati—passes away; na—not; hi—certainly; yatra—where; api—even; samayaù—time; bhaje—I worship; çveta-dvépam—Çvetadvépa; tam—that; aham—I; iha—here; golokam—Goloka; iti—thus; yam—which; vidantaù—know; te—they; santaù—self-realized souls; kñiti—in this world; virala—seldom; cäräù—going; katipaye—few.

TRANSLATION

I worship that transcendental seat, known as Çvetadvépa where as loving consorts the Lakñmés in their unalloyed spiritual essence practice the amorous service of the Supreme Lord Kåñëa as their only lover; where every tree is a transcendental purpose tree; where the soil is the purpose gem, all water is nectar, every word is a song, every gait is a dance, the flute is the favorite attendant, effulgence is full of transcendental bliss and the supreme spiritual entities are all enjoyable and tasty, where numberless milk cows always emit transcendental oceans of milk; where there is eternal existence of transcendental time, who is ever present and without past or future and hence is not subject to the quality of passing

away even for the space of half a moment. That realm is known as Goloka only to a very few self-realized souls in this world.

PURPORT

That region which jévas attain by the best performance of their rasa-bhajana, though purely transcendental, is by no means devoid of variegatedness. The nondifferentiated region is attained by indulging in anger, fear and delusion. The devotees attain Goloka, the transcendental region above Vaikuëöha, according to the quality of rasa of the respective services. In reality that region is no other than Çvetadvépa or “the White Island,” being exceedingly pure. Those, who attain the highest rasa in the shape of the realization of pure devotion in this world, viewing the reality of Çvetadvépa in Gokula, Våndävana and Navadvépa within this mundane world, designate the same as “Goloka.” In that transcendental region of Goloka there are always visible, in their supreme beauty, all the distinctive entities that are incorporated in the pure cognitive principle, viz., the lover and His beloved ones, trees and creepers, mountains, rivers and forests, water, speech, movement, music of the flute, the sun and the moon, tasted and taste (i.e., the unthinkable wonders of the 64 aesthetic arts), milk cows yielding nectarean flow of milk and transcendental ever-existing time.

Descriptions that supply the clue to Goloka are found in various places in the Vedas and the other çästras such as the Puräëas, tantras etc. The Chåndogya says: brüyäd yävan vä ayam äkäças tävan eña antar hâda äkäçaù ubhe asmin dyävä-päthivé antar eva samähite. ubhäv agniç ca väyuç ca sürya—candramasäv ubhau vidyun nakñaträëi yac cäsyehtësti yac ca nästi sarvaà tad asmin samähitam iti.

The sum and substance of it is that all the variegatedness of this mundane world and much more variety over and above the mundane, are to be found in Goloka. The variety in the transcendental world is fully centralized whereas in the mundane world it is not so and hence productive of weal and woe. The centralized variety of Goloka is unalloyed and full of transcendental cognitive joy. The Vedas and sädhus practicing devotion revealed by the Vedas, by availing the support of their individual cognitional aptitude actuated by devotion, may have a sight of divine realm

and by the power of the grace of Kåñëa their tiny cognitive faculty attaining the quality of infinitude they are enabled to be on the level of the plane of enjoyments of Kåñëa.

There is a hidden meaning of the proposition “even the Supreme that is also nevertheless the object of enjoyment” (param api tad äsvädyam api ca). The word param api indicates that Çré Kåñëa is the only Truth Absolute in all the transcendental blissful principles and tad äsvädyam api means His object of enjoyment. The glory of Rādhā’s love for Kåñëa, tasty quality (rasa) of Kåñëa that is realized by Rādhā and the bliss of which Rādhā is conscious in the process of such realization, all these threefold bhāvas (emotional entities) becoming available for enjoyment by Kåñëa He attains His personality of Çré Gaurasundara. It is also this that constitutes the transcendental bliss of the delicious loving (rasa) service manifested by Çré Gaurasundara. This also eternally exists only in the selfsame Çvetadvépa.

Bs 5.57

TEXT 57

TEXT

athovāca mahā-viñëur

bhagavantaà prajāpatim

brahman mahattva-vijñāne

prajā-sarge ca cen matiù

pañca-çlokém imāà vidyāà

vatsa dattāà nibodha me

SYNONYMS

atha—then; uvāca—said; mahā-viñëuù—the Supreme Lord;

bhagavantam—unto the glorious; prajāpatim—Lord Brahmā; brahman—O Brahmā; mahattva—of the glory (of Godhead); vijñāne—in real knowledge; prajā-sarge—in creating offspring; ca—and; cet—if; matiù—the inclination; pañca-çlokém—five çlokas; imām—this; vidyām—science; vatsa—O beloved; dattām—given; nibodha—hear; me—from Me.

TRANSLATION

On hearing these hymns containing the essence of the truth, the Supreme Lord Kāñëa said to Brahmā, “Brahmā, if you experience the inclination to create offspring by being endowed with the real knowledge of the glory of Godhead, listen, My beloved, from Me to this science set forth in the following five çlokas.

PURPORT

The Supreme Lord became propitious when Brahmā with great eagerness chanted the names, “Kāñëa” and “Govinda” expressive of the form, attribute and pastimes. Brahmā was actuated by the desire for mundane creation. Kāñëa then said to Brahmā how pure unalloyed devotion can be practiced by souls engaged in worldly occupations by combining the same with the desire for carrying out the behest of the Supreme Lord. “The knowledge absolute is knowledge of the glory of Godhead; if you want to procreate offspring being endowed with such knowledge, listen attentively to the science of devotion that is contained in the following five çlokas.”

(How bhakti is practiced by performing worldly duties in the form of carrying out the commands of the Supreme Lord, is being described).

Bs 5.58

TEXT 58

TEXT

prabuddhe jñāna-bhaktibhyām

ätmany änanda-cin-mayé

udety anuttamä bhaktir

bhagavat-prema-lakñaëä

SYNONYMS

prabuddhe—when excited; jñāna—by cognition or knowledge; bhaktibhyām—and by devotional service; ātmani—in the pure spirit soul; ānanda-cit-mayi—full of knowledge and bliss; udeti—is awakened; anuttamä—superexcellent; bhakti—devotion; bhagavat—for Kāñṛä; prema—by love; lakñaëä—characterized.

TRANSLATION

When the pure spiritual experience is excited by means of cognition and service [bhakti], superexcellent unalloyed devotion characterized by love for Godhead is awakened towards Kāñṛä, the beloved of all souls.

PURPORT

Real knowledge is nothing but knowledge of one's relationship to the Absolute. Real knowledge is identical with the knowledge of subjective natures of cit (animate), acit (inanimate) and Kāñṛä and of their mutual relationship. Here mental speculation is not alluded to, since that is antagonistic to service (bhakti). The knowledge that embraces only the first seven of the ten basic principles (daça-mūla) is the knowledge of relationship. The substantive nature of the spiritual function (abhidheya) inculcated by the science of devotion hearing, chanting, meditation, tending His holy feet, worshiping by rituals, making prostrations, doing menial service, practicing friendship and surrendering oneself are identical with practicing the search for Kāñṛä. It is specifically described in Bhakti-rasāmāta-sindhu. Devotion (bhakti) characterized by love for Godhead makes her appearance by being awakened by such knowledge and practice. Such devotion is superexcellent bhakti and is no other than the final object of attainment of all spiritual endeavor of the individual soul (jēva).

Bs 5.59

TEXT 59

TEXT

pramäëais tat-sad-äcärais

tad-abhyäsair nirantaram

bodhayan ätmanätmänaà

bhaktim apy uttamää labhet

SYNONYMS

pramäëaiù—by scriptural evidence; tat—of them; sat-äcäraiù—by theistic conduct; tat—of them; abhyäsaiù—by practice; nirantaram—constantly; bodhayan—awakening; ätmanä—by one’s own intelligence; ätmänam—the self; bhaktim—devotion; api—certainly; uttamäm—the highest; labhet—one can attain.

TRANSLATION

The highest devotion is attained by slow degrees by the method of constant endeavor for self-realization with the help of scriptural evidence, theistic conduct and perseverance in practice.

PURPORT

Evidence—the devotional scriptures, e.g., Çrémad-Bhāgavatam, the Vedas, the Purāṇas, the Gētā, etc. Theistic conduct—the conduct of pious persons (sādhus) who are pure devotees and the conduct of those pious persons who practice devotion to Godhead actuated by spontaneous love. Practice—to learn about the ten basic principles (daṣa-mūla) from the ṣāstras and on receiving the name of Hari as laid down in the same, embodying the name, form, quality and activity of the Divinity. to practice

the chanting of the name by serving Him night and day. By this are meant study of the *çästras* and association with the *sädhus*. The tenfold offense to holy name ceases by serving the name of Hari and simultaneously practicing pious conduct. “Practice” is no other than following the mode of service of the name practiced by the *sädhus* without offense. By perseverance in such practice and devotion characterized by love which is the fruit of spiritual endeavor makes her appearance in the pure essence of the soul.

Bs 5.60

TEXT 60

TEXT

yasyäù *çreyas-karaà* nästi

yayä *nirvåtim* äpnuyät

yä *sädhayati* mäm eva

bhaktià *täm* eva *sädhayet*

SYNONYMS

yasyäù—than which; *çreyaù-karam*—superior well-being; na—not; asti—there is; yayä—by which; *nirvåtim*—supreme bliss; äpnuyät—one can attain; yä—who; *sädhayati*—leads; mäm—to Me; eva—certainly; bhaktim—loving devotion; *täm*—that; eva—indeed; *sädhayet*—one should perform.

TRANSLATION

These preliminary practices of devotion [*sädhana-bhakti*] are conducive to the realization of loving devotion. [Loving devotion]—than whom there is no superior well-being, who goes hand in hand with the attainment of the exclusive state of supreme bliss and who can lead to Myself.

PURPORT

The jéva-soul has no better well-being than loving devotion. In this is realized the final beatitude of jévas. The lotus feet of Kåñëa are attainable only by loving devotion. He who cultivates the preliminary devotional activities anxiously keeping in view that realized state of devotion can alone attain to that object of all endeavor. None else can have the same.

Bs 5.61

TEXT 61

TEXT

dharmän anyän parityajya

mäm ekaà bhaja viçvasan

yädâçé yädâçé çraddhä

siddhir bhavati tädâçé

kurvan nirantaraà karma

loko 'yam anuvartate

tenaiva karmaëä dhyäyan

mäà paräà bhaktim icchati

SYNONYMS

dharmän—meritorious performances; anyän—other; parityajya—abandoning; mäm— Me; ekam—alone; bhaja—serve; viçvasan—having faith; yädâçé yädâçé—just as; çraddhä—faith; siddhiù—realization; bhavati—arises; tädâçé—corresponding; kurvan—performing; nirantaram—ceaselessly; karma—activities; lokaù ayam—the people of this

world; anuvartate—pursue; tena—by those; eva—indeed; karmaëä—deeds; dhyāyan—meditating; mām—upon Me; parām—supreme; bhaktim—devotion; icchatī—one obtains.

TRANSLATION

Abandoning all meritorious performances serve Me with faith. The realization will correspond to the nature of one's faith. The people of the world act ceaselessly in pursuance of some ideal. By meditating on Me by means of those deeds one will obtain devotion characterized by love in the shape of the supreme service.

PURPORT

The function characterized by unalloyed devotion is the real function of all individual souls (jévas). All other varieties of function are activities of the external cases. These exoteric and esoteric dharmas (functions) are manifold, e.g., nondifferential knowledge of the Brahman aiming at extinction of individuality. the aññāga-yoga-dharma having as its goal attainment of the state of exclusive existence (kaivalya), atheistical fruitive ritualism aiming at material enjoyment, jñāna-yoga-dharma seeking to combine knowledge with fruitive activity and the practice of the function of barren asceticism. Getting rid of all these, serve Me by pure devotion rooted in faith. Exclusive faith in Me is trust. Faith in the form of trust by the process of gradual purification tends to become a constant engagement (niññhā), an object of liking (ruci), of attachment (āsakti) and a real sentiment (bhāva). The more transparent the faith, the greater the degree of realization. If you ask—How will the preservation and conduct of worldly affairs be feasible if one is continuously engaged in the endeavor for the realization of bhakti? What also will be the nature of the endeavor for the realization of bhakti when the body will perish consequent on the cessation of the function of the body and of society?

In order to strike at the root of this misgiving the Supreme Lord says, “This world subsists by the constant performance of certain activities. Fill all these activities with meditation of Me. This will destroy the quality that makes those activities appear as acts done by you. They will then be of the

nature of My service (bhakti).

“Mankind live by the threefold activities of body. mind and society. Eating, seating, walking, resting, sleeping, cleansing the body. covering the body. etc., are the various bodily activities; thinking, recollecting, retaining an impression, becoming aware of an entity. feeling pleasure and pain, etc., are the mental feats; marrying, practicing reciprocal relationship between the king and subject, practicing brotherhood, attending at sacrificial meetings, offering oblations, digging wells, tanks, etc., for the benefit of the people, maintaining one’s relations, practicing hospitality. observing proper civic conduct, showing due respect to others are the various social activities. When these acts are performed for one’s selfish enjoyment, they are called karma-käëòà; when the desire for attainment of freedom from activity by knowledge underlies these actions, they are termed jïäna-yoga or karma-yoga. And when these activities are managed to be performed in this way that is conducive to our endeavor for attainment of bhakti they are called jïäna-bhakta-yoga, i.e., the subsidiary devotional practices. But only those activities that are characterized by the principle of pure worship are called bhakti proper. My meditation is practiced in every act when bhakti proper is practiced in due time while performing the subsidiary devotional activities in one’s intercourse with the ungodly people of this world. In such position, a jéva does not become apathetic to Godhead even by performing those worldly activities. This constitutes the practice of looking inwards, i.e., turning towards one’s real self, vide Éçopaniñad—

éçäväsyaṁ idaṁ sarvaṁ

yat kiñca jagatyāṁ jagat

tena tyaktena bhuñjétha

mā gādhaṁ kasya svid dhanam

The commentator says in regards to this, tena éça-tyaktena visãñöena. The real significance being that if whatever is accepted be received as favor vouchsafed by the Supreme Lord, the worldly activity will cease to be such and will turn into service of Godhead (bhakti). So Éçäväsya says kurvann

eveha karmäëi... karma lipyate nare.

If the worldly acts are performed in the above manner one does not get entangled in karma even in hundreds of years of worldly life. The meaning of these two mantras from the jñāna point of view is renouncement of the fruits of one's worldly actions; but from the bhakti point of view they mean the attainment of Kāñṛēa's favor (prasādam) by their transfer to His account. In this method, which is the path of arcana, you should do your duties of the world by the meditation of worshiping Godhead thereby. Brahmā cherishes the desire for creation in his heart. If that creative desire is practiced by conjoining the same with the meditation of obeying therein the command of the Supreme Lord, then it will be a subsidiary spiritual function (gauṛēa-dharma) being helpful for the growth of the disposition for the service of the Divinity by reason of its characteristic of seeking the protection of Godhead. It was certainly proper to instruct Brahmā in this manner. There is no occasion for such instruction in the case of a jēva in whom the spontaneous aversion for entities other than Kāñṛēa manifests itself on his attainment of the substantive entity of spiritual devotion (bhāva).

Bs 5.62

TEXT 62

TEXT

ahaà hi viçvasya carācarasya

bējaà pradhānaà prakātiù pumääç ca

mayāhitaà teja idaà bibharñi

vidhe vidhehi tvam atho jaganti

SYNONYMS

aham—I; hi—certainly; viçvasya—of the world; cara-acarasya—of

animate and inanimate objects; béjam—the seed; pradhānam—the substance of matter; prakāti—the material cause; pumān—the puruṇa; ca—and; mayā—by Me; āhitam—conferred; teja—the fiery energy; idam—this; bibharāṇi—you bear; vidhe—O Brahmā; vidhehi—regulate; tvam—you; atha u—now; jaganti—the worlds.

TRANSLATION

“Listen, O Vidhi, I am the seed, i.e., the fundamental principle, of this world of animate and inanimate objects. I am pradhāna [the substance of matter], I am prakāti [material cause] and I am puruṇa [efficient cause]. This fiery energy that belongs specially to the Brahman, that inheres in you, has also been conferred by Me. It is by bearing this fiery energy that you regulate this phenomenal world of animate and inanimate objects.”

PURPORT

Certain thinkers conclude that the nondifferentiated Brahman is the ultimate entity and by undergoing self-delusion (vivarta) exhibits the consciousness of differentiation; or, the limiting principle itself (Māyā), when it is limited, is the phenomenal world and is itself the Brahman, in its unlimited position; or, the Brahman is the substance and this phenomenal world is the reflection; or, everything is an illusion of the jēva. Some think that Godhead is evidently a separate entity. Jēva is another different entity. and the phenomenal world, although it is a singular principle, exists separately as an eternally independent entity; or, Godhead, is the substantive entity and all other entities, as cit and a-cit attributes, are one in principle. Some suppose that by the force of inconceivable potency sometimes the monistic and sometimes the dualistic principle is realized as the truth. Some again arrive at the conclusion that the theory of the nondual minus all potency is meaningless; whence the Brahman is the one eternally unalloyed entity vested with the pure potency.

These speculations have originated from Veda relying on the support of the Vedānta-sūtra. In these speculations although there is no truth that holds good in all positions, there is yet a certain measure of truth. Not to speak of the anti-Vedic speculations Sāṅkhya, Patañjala, Nyāya and

Vaiṣeṇika, nor even of Pūrva-mémääsä which is fond of exclusive fruitive activity in conformity with the teaching of one portion of the Veda, the bodies of opinions detailed above have also come into existence by relying outwardly on the Vedānta itself. By discarding all these speculations, you and your bona fide community should adopt the ultimate principle identical with the doctrine of acintya-bhedābheda (inconceivable simultaneous distinction and nondifference). This will make you eligible for being a true devotee. The basic principle is that this animate world is made up of jévas and the inanimate world is constituted of matter. Of these all the jévas have been manifested by My supreme (parā) potency and this phenomenal world has been manifested by My secondary (aparā) potency. I am the cause of all causes. In other words, I regulate all of them by the power of My will although I am not a different entity from the marginal and material (taöasthä and acit) potencies. By the transformation of those distinct potencies pradhāna (substantive material principle), prakāti (material cause) and puruṇa (efficient cause) have been produced. Hence although as regards the subjective nature of all potency I am pradhāna, prakāti and puruṇa, yet as the possessor of power I am eternally distinct from all those potencies. This simultaneous distinction and nondifference has also sprung from My inconceivable power. So let the attainment of love for Kåñëa by the practice of pure devotion through the knowledge of their mutual true relationship that subsists between the jéva, the jaòä (matter) and Kåñëa based on the principle of inconceivable simultaneous distinction and non-difference, be My instruction for being handed down in the order of spiritual preceptual succession in your community (Çré Brahma-sampradāya).